



**BOX HILL REPORTER
DISTRICT CRICKET ASSOCIATION INC.**

COMPETITION RULES

SEASON 2026/27

The Rules that apply to all BHRDCA Competitions
Competition Rules • Senior Playing Conditions • Junior Playing Conditions

COMPETITION



COMMUNITY



CONNECTION

Table of Contents

1.	GENERAL MATTERS APPLICABLE TO ALL BHRDCA COMPETITIONS.....	4
1.1.	LAW OF CRICKET.....	4
1.2.	APPLICATION AND DEFINITIONS.....	5
1.3.	REGISTRATION.....	6
1.4.	TRANSFERS & PERMITS.....	7
1.5.	TEAM SHEETS & ADMINISTRATION.....	7
1.6.	GROUNDS & EQUIPMENT.....	8
1.7.	UMPIRES.....	10
1.8.	CODE OF BEHAVIOUR.....	12
1.9.	INJURY CODE.....	12
1.10.	TRIBUNAL PROCEDURES.....	12
1.11.	APPEAL PROCEDURES.....	12
1.12.	YELLOW & RED DISCIPLINARY CARD.....	12
1.13.	PLAYER POINTS SYSTEM.....	12
1.14.	SCHEDULE OF ADMINISTRATION FEES.....	12
1.15.	EXTREME CONDITIONS POLICY.....	12
1.16.	PLAYING ATTIRE POLICY.....	12
1.17.	COMMUNICATION FROM CLUBS.....	13
1.18.	ALCOHOL & SMOKING / VAPING AT PUBLIC RECREATION RESERVES.....	13
1.19.	MEMBER PROTECTION.....	13
2.	BHRDCA COMPETITIONS.....	14
2.1.	COMPETITION MANAGEMENT.....	14
2.2.	COMPETITION FORMATS.....	14
2.3.	COMPETITION POINTS.....	14
2.4.	ABANDONED ROUNDS.....	14
3.	SENIOR COMPETITIONS.....	15
3.1.	GRADES.....	15
3.2.	MATCH SCHEDULING.....	15
3.3.	MATCH POINTS.....	16
3.4.	FORFEITS.....	17
3.5.	READINESS FOR PLAY & TOSS.....	17
3.6.	DRINKS BREAKS.....	18
3.7.	MATCH-DAY REQUIREMENTS.....	18
3.8.	PLAYER ELIGIBILITY.....	21
3.9.	PLAYER POINTS SYSTEM.....	21
4.1.	SENIOR MEN'S - TWO-DAY MATCH RULES.....	22

4.2.	SENIOR MEN'S - ONE-DAY MATCH RULES.....	29
4.3.	SPLIT INNINGS MATCH RULES.....	35
4.4.	SENIOR FINALS.....	37
5.	JUNIOR COMPETITIONS.....	38
5.1.	MANAGEMENT OF TEAMS.....	38
5.2.	AGE GROUPS.....	38
5.3.	GRADES & FORMATS.....	38
5.4.	MATCH SCHEDULING.....	39
5.5.	MATCH POINTS.....	40
5.6.	FORFEITS.....	41
5.7.	READINESS FOR PLAY & TOSS.....	41
5.8.	INTERVALS BETWEEN INNINGS & DRINKS BREAKS.....	42
5.9.	MATCH-DAY REQUIREMENTS.....	42
5.10.	PLAYER ELIGIBILITY.....	45
5.11.	JUNIOR REGRADING.....	45
5.12.	JUNIOR COMPETITIONS - MATCH RULES.....	46
5.13.	JUNIOR FINALS.....	52
5.14.	FAST 9's & SUPER 7's.....	53
6.	APPENDIX.....	55
6.1.	CODE OF BEHAVIOUR.....	55
6.2.	INJURY CODE.....	58
6.3.	TRIBUNAL PROCEDURES.....	59
6.4.	BHRDCA APPEAL PROCEDURES.....	62
6.5.	YELLOW & RED DISCIPLINARY CARD.....	64
6.6.	PLAYER POINTS SYSTEM.....	66
6.7.	SCHEDULE OF ADMINISTRATION FEES.....	69
6.8.	EXTREME CONDITIONS POLICY.....	71
6.9.	PLAYING ATTIRE POLICY.....	78
6.10.	UMPIRE PAYMENT FEE SCHEDULE.....	80
6.11.	BEST CONDUCTED CLUB AWARD.....	81

1. GENERAL MATTERS APPLICABLE TO ALL BHRDCA COMPETITIONS

1.1. LAW OF CRICKET

- 1.1.1.** The Laws of Cricket (2017 – 4th Edition 2026) shall apply to **Senior Matches**, except where otherwise provided for in these Rules and with the exceptions listed below where the MCC Laws of Cricket Code do not apply to BHRDCA Competitions.
- (i) Laws with reference to, or the application of Turf or natural surface cricket;
 - (ii) Law 24: which covers Fielder's absence and Substitutes (See below for exception),
 - (iii) Law 37.4: Returning the Ball to a Fielder - Where a Player returns the ball to any fielder when the ball is dead or out of play, the Player shall not be given out.
 - (iv) Law 38.3: Non-Striker leaving their ground early; MANKAD mode of dismissal - NO batter in ANY SENIOR GRADE may be dismissed by "MANKAD" mode of dismissal. Umpires (or where no Umpire is appointed); Captains are to warn batters as to their obligations not to use this Rule as an opportunity to "steal runs". Subsequent breaches are to result in a "dead ball" call, no run recorded and the ball re-bowled.
 - (v) Law 42: which covers Player's misconduct and levels of sanctions.
- 1.1.2.** The Laws of Cricket (2017 – 4th Edition 2026) shall apply to **Junior Matches**, except where otherwise provided for in these Rules and with the exceptions listed below where the MCC Laws of Cricket Code do not apply to BHRDCA Competitions.
- (i) Laws with reference to, or the application of Turf or natural surface cricket;
 - (ii) Laws with reference to Penalty Runs;
 - (iii) Law 24: which covers Fielder's absence and Substitutes (See below for exception),
 - (iv) Law 37.4: Returning the Ball to a Fielder - Where a Player returns the ball to any fielder when the ball is dead or out of play, the Player shall not be given out.
 - (v) Law 38.3: Non-Striker leaving their ground early; MANKAD mode of dismissal - NO batter in ANY SENIOR GRADE may be dismissed by "MANKAD" mode of dismissal. Umpires (or where no Umpire is appointed); Captains are to warn batters as to their obligations not to use this Rule as an opportunity to "steal runs". Subsequent breaches are to result in a "dead ball" call, no run recorded and the ball re-bowled.
 - (vi) Law 41: Unfair Play, where the Law provides for the awarding of Penalty Runs;
 - (vii) Law 42: which covers Player's misconduct and levels of sanctions.

1.2. APPLICATION AND DEFINITIONS

1.2.1. These Rules shall apply to all BHRDCA Competition Matches.

1.2.2. These Rules supersede all previous BHRDCA Competition Rules to the extent that a matter is expressly addressed in these Rules. Where a matter is not addressed in these Rules, the corresponding 2025/26 BHRDCA Competition Rule or Playing Condition shall continue to apply, unless otherwise determined by the Committee of Management.

1.2.3. These Rules shall be subject to amendment in BHRDCA's discretion. If any BHRDCA Rules are amended, the Association will notify Clubs of the amendment(s).

1.2.4. For the purpose of these Rules, the following definitions apply:

- (i) **Abandoned** means a Competition Fixture which has failed to commence for any reason or has commenced but has been stopped by the Match Official prior to its conclusion in accordance with Rule 2.4.
- (ii) **Administrator** means the BHRDCA Competition Administrator.
- (iii) **Association** means Box Hill Reporter District Cricket Association (BHRDCA).
- (iv) **Affiliate** refers to a BHRDCA Affiliated Club/Association.
- (v) **Appeal Board** refers to a body empowered to hear and/or determine the outcome of an appeal.
- (vi) **Appeal Panel** refers to a body empowered only to hear an appeal and report to an Appeal Board with or without a recommendation.
- (vii) **BHRDCA** means Box Hill Reporter District Cricket Association.
- (viii) **Bye** means a scheduled round in which a Team has no opponent and no Match is played.
- (ix) **Chairperson** means the Chair of a relevant Appeal Board or Appeal Panel as appropriate.
- (x) **Club** means a Club affiliated to BHRDCA.
- (xi) **Club Administrator** means a person authorised by a Club to administer that Club's PlayHQ and BHRDCA competition requirements.
- (xii) **Club Grade** means the relative ranking of a Club's Senior Teams from highest to lowest.
- (xiii) **Code of Behaviour** means the BHRDCA Code of Behaviour as outlined in Appendix 5.1.
- (xiv) **CoM** means BHRDCA Committee of Management.
- (xv) **Competition Grade** means the relative ranking of all Grades conducted by the BHRDCA.
- (xvi) **Competition Management System** means the competition administration platform used by BHRDCA to manage registrations, Player movements, Team Sheets, scoring, Match Results and other competition administration functions. For the 2026/27 season, the Competition Management System is PlayHQ.
- (xvii) **Compulsory Closure** means the closure of an innings because the applicable maximum overs or compulsory-closure condition has been reached.
- (xviii) **CV** means Cricket Victoria.
- (xix) **Dispensation** means written approval by the CoM for a Player to participate outside an otherwise applicable Junior age requirement.

- (xx) **DLS** means the Duckworth-Lewis-Stern method used to calculate revised targets and results in interrupted Matches where these Rules expressly provide for its application.
- (xxi) **Eligibility** means whether a Player satisfies all registration, age, permit, dispensation, grade-movement, Player Points System and finals-qualification requirements that apply under these Rules.
- (xxii) **End Date** refers to the last day of a suspension.
- (xxiii) **Finals Series** means the Semi Final and Grand Final matches conducted after the Home & Away season.
- (xxiv) **Home & Away Season** means all fixtured competition Matches before the Finals Series.
- (xxv) **Permit** means approval granted under Regulation 1.4 allowing a Player to participate in circumstances that otherwise require specific BHRDCA approval.
- (xxvi) **PlayHQ** means the Competition Management System.
- (xxvii) **PPS** means the Player Points System.
- (xxviii) **Registered Player** means a Player registered on PlayHQ in accordance with these Rules.
- (xxix) **Team Sheet** means the electronic Team Sheet lodged on PlayHQ for a Match.
- (xxx) **Transfer** means the movement of a Player between Clubs.
- (xxxi) **Umpire** means the Umpire (including any emergency or other Umpires) appointed to officiate in a Match.
- (xxxii) **VMCU** means the Victorian Metropolitan Cricket Union.
- (xxxiii) **Washed-out** means a scheduled period of play in which play cannot commence or continue because the ground, weather, light or other playing conditions are unsuitable for play.

1.3. REGISTRATION

- 1.3.1. Except where a Junior Fill-In Player is permitted under the Junior Competition Rules, all Players must be registered on PlayHQ before participating for their Club for the first time in the season.
- 1.3.2. A Club must ensure the Player's PlayHQ registration contains the information required by BHRDCA and Cricket Australia.
- 1.3.3. A Player who has not played in another Association during the current season may register up to completion of the Home & Away season, subject to the Player Points System and any other eligibility restriction in these Rules.
- 1.3.4. A Club that fields an ineligible or unregistered Player may be deemed to have forfeited the Match and may be subject to the applicable sanction under Regulation 1.14 and Appendix 5.7.
- 1.3.5. It is the absolute responsibility of each Club and Player to ensure that the Player is eligible to participate under these Rules.

1.4. TRANSFERS & PERMITS

1.4.1. Once registered, should a Player wish to transfer to another Club either prior to or during the season, the following steps must take place:

- (i) Player or Club Administrator submits a transfer request via PlayHQ.
- (ii) The Players existing Club, destination Club and BHRDCA approve the transfer request.
- (iii) Once all parties approve, the Player will receive an email to complete their new registration.
- (iv) Should a transfer request sit as pending, following the fifth day, the request will lapse and automatically be approved.

1.4.2. Once registered, should a Player wish to play with another Club or Association either prior to or during the season, the following steps must take place:

- (i) Player or Club Administrator submits a permit request via PlayHQ.
- (ii) The Players existing Club, destination Club and BHRDCA approve the permit request.
- (iii) Once all parties approve, the Player will receive an email to complete their new registration.
- (iv) Should a permit request sit as pending, following the fifth day, the request will lapse and automatically be approved.

1.5. TEAM SHEETS & ADMINISTRATION

1.5.1. Electronic Team Sheets must be lodged on PlayHQ for each participating Senior Team before the Match commences.

1.5.2. All Players (including 12th/13th players where applicable) must be listed.

1.5.3. Late changes may be made only in consultation with the Match Umpire(s) and/or the opposing Captain.

1.5.4. A Team which fails to lodge a Team Sheet may be deemed to have forfeited the match.

1.6. GROUNDS & EQUIPMENT

1.6.1. Playing Surface

- (i) All Matches shall be played on the surface recommended by the CoM and approved by the Clubs. The pitch material and playing surface must be at least 1.8 metres wide.

1.6.2. The Boundary

- (i) Where a ground has neither a fence nor clearly defined boundary, it shall be clearly identified by boundary markers.
- (ii) Markers are to be of a distinctive colour and spaced approximately 20 meters apart.
- (iii) The boundary is to be a straight line between markers unless otherwise marked.

1.6.3. The Stumps

- (i) Two sets of regulation-size wickets, with 3 stumps and 2 bails at each end, are placed opposite and parallel to each other.
- (ii) Stumps must be regulation size and shape, with grooves at the top for the bails.
- (iii) Bails must be regulation size and fit correctly on top of the stumps without moving them.
- (iv) Umpires may agree to play without bails if necessary at both ends, with bails replaced as soon as possible.

1.6.4. The Ball

- (i) A new leather ball conforming to the M.C.C. Laws of Cricket, together with a suitable substitute ball, shall be provided by each Team.
- (ii) A new ball shall be used at the commencement of each Teams first innings.
- (iii) A new ball may be used at the commencement of a second innings, however if a used ball is used to start a second innings, a new ball cannot be claimed.
- (iv) A second new ball during the progress of any single innings in any match may be taken after the conclusion of the 80th over of that innings.
- (v) Each ball must be approved by the BHRDCA.

1.6.5. Scoreboard

- (i) All Clubs must have an operative scoreboard clearly readable from the wicket, with it being the responsibility of the Home Team for each match.

1.6.6. Crease Markings

- (i) Clubs must ensure that crease lines are kept painted on all synthetic wickets.
- (ii) Shield Grades shall have appropriate popping crease lines marked at square leg and point for guidance of Umpires and runners.

1.6.7. Change Rooms

- (i) Clubs must ensure at all grounds provided with pavilions accessible to the home Club, containing away change rooms and Umpires change rooms, these rooms are to be made available to both the away Team and Umpires.

1.6.8. Use of Artificial Lighting

- (i) In BHRDCA afternoon fixtured matches, artificial lighting (i.e., light towers, ground lights, car headlights, etc.) is not permitted.
- (ii) The use of artificial lighting cannot be used to augment natural light when that natural light falls below the standards expected and controlled by the Appointed Umpire(s), or when no Umpire stands, by mutual agreement between the Captains.

1.6.9. Grounds & Equipment Breaches

- (i) Clubs in breach of any Grounds & Equipment regulations, may be subject to a fine in accordance with Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.

1.7. UMPIRES

1.7.1. Appointments

- (i) Umpires for all grades shall be selected and appointed by the Umpires Appointments Committee.
- (ii) Should only one neutral Umpire be appointed for a match, the square leg Umpire is to be provided by the batting Team.

1.7.2. Umpire Fees

- (i) Both the home & away Team will be charged 50% of the relevant Umpire(s) fee each match day including reserve days.
- (ii) If play is terminated before the scheduled tea break from extreme conditions, bad light or exceptional circumstances, the Umpires shall be paid 50% of their match fee if in attendance, and if after the scheduled tea break, full fees shall be paid.
- (iii) Umpire fees must be paid per process directed by BHRDCA CoM.
- (iv) Please refer to Appendix 5.10 which sets out the Schedule of Umpire Payment Fees relevant to all BHRDCA Competitions.

1.7.3. Attendance

- (i) Umpires appointed for each round of matches must be at the ground at least 45 minutes before the scheduled match commencement.
- (ii) Umpires must notify Captains or their deputies that they are within 15 minutes of the starting time.

1.7.4. Conduct of Match

- (i) Before and during a match the Umpire(s) shall ensure that the conduct of the match, and the implements used are strictly in accordance with the laws.
- (ii) The Umpire(s) are the final judges of the fitness of the ground, extreme conditions, and light in the event of decisions being left to them.
- (iii) All disputes during play shall be determined by the Umpire(s), and if they disagree the actual state of things shall continue.

1.7.5. Umpires' Report on Match

- (i) In addition to procedural requirements published by the Association from time to time, Umpires for each match shall forward to the Association Secretary and Competition Administrator by 8.00pm on the Tuesday following the completion of the match, using the prescribed BHRDCA report form.

1.7.6. Code of Behaviour Violations

- (i) The Umpire(s) shall report all instances of Code of Behaviour violations via the prescribed form, 48 hours post the completion of the match.

1.7.7. Breaches of Rules

- (i) Umpires must report any breach of these Rules to the Association Secretary and Competition Administrator by 8.00pm on Tuesday following the completion of the match via the relevant form.
- (ii) Following receipt of report, the BHRDCA will confirm via phone and email that alleged offending Clubs and Players are notified.

1.7.8. Attire

- (i) All Umpires shall officiate in the attire as directed by the BHRDCA Umpires Association.
- (ii) Where there is only one official Umpire, the square leg umpire must be dressed with some distinguishing apparel (i.e., coloured vest, dark pants, etc.) and appropriate covered footwear (i.e., shoes/runners, no thongs/bare feet, etc.).
- (iii) Where no official Umpire is present, officiating Club umpires must be appropriately attired (shirt, covered footwear) with at least one item of distinguishing apparel.
- (iv) Breaches of Rule 1.7.8 are subject to penalties under Regulation 1.14 and BHRDCA Schedule of Administrative Fees.

1.7.9. Umpires' Association

- (i) Any Umpire appointed by this Association must become a member of the Umpires Association and attend their meetings.
- (ii) An Umpire infringing any requirement of Rule 1.7 shall appear when called upon by the CoM or the Umpires' Committee of Management, failing which they shall be dealt with as either Committee sees fit.

1.8. CODE OF BEHAVIOUR

- 1.8.1.** Please refer to Appendix 5.1 which sets out the Codes of Behavior relevant to all BHRDCA Competitions.

1.9. INJURY CODE

- 1.9.1.** Please refer to Appendix 5.2 which sets out the Injury Code relevant to all BHRDCA Competitions.

1.10. TRIBUNAL PROCEDURES

- 1.10.1.** Please refer to Appendix 5.3 which sets out the Tribunal Procedures relevant to all BHRDCA Competitions.

1.11. APPEAL PROCEDURES

- 1.11.1.** Please refer to Appendix 5.4 which sets out the Appeal Procedures relevant to all BHRDCA Competitions.

1.12. YELLOW & RED DISCIPLINARY CARD

- 1.12.1.** Please refer to Appendix 5.5 which sets out the Yellow & Red Disciplinary Card process relevant to all BHRDCA Competitions.

1.13. PLAYER POINTS SYSTEM

- 1.13.1.** Please refer to Appendix 5.6, which sets out the BHRDCA Player Points System applicable to the relevant Senior Men's Shield Grades.

1.14. SCHEDULE OF ADMINISTRATION FEES

- 1.14.1.** Please refer to Appendix 5.7 which sets out the Schedule of Administration Fees relevant to all BHRDCA Competitions.

1.15. EXTREME CONDITIONS POLICY

- 1.15.1.** Please refer to Appendix 5.8 which sets out the BHRDCA Extreme Conditions Policy relevant to all BHRDCA Competitions.

1.16. PLAYING ATTIRE POLICY

- 1.16.1.** Please refer to Appendix 5.9 which sets out the BHRDCA Playing Attire requirements relevant to all BHRDCA Competitions.

1.17. COMMUNICATION FROM CLUBS

- 1.17.1.** No correspondence (email or otherwise) will be considered by any BHRDCA CoM Club representative unless the individual corresponding is authorised to do so by the Club President and/or Secretary. Where the Club President and/or Secretary is copied into the correspondence and thereby kept informed of its contents, the correspondence will be considered.

1.18. ALCOHOL & SMOKING / VAPING AT PUBLIC RECREATION RESERVES

- 1.18.1.** Consumption of intoxicating liquor at a match by competing players during the hours of play is strictly prohibited. Clubs found in breach may be subject to a fine in accordance with Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.
- 1.18.2.** Smoking / Vaping at Public Recreation Reserves: The Tobacco Act (1987) prohibits smoking at Council facilities with further information below:
- (i) Pavilions – Smoking / Vaping in all Council buildings is strictly prohibited.
 - (ii) Sports fields – Smoking / Vaping is now unlawful within 10 metres of outdoor facilities including within and without outdoor sporting venues during organised sporting events or training sessions.
 - (iii) The ban also applies to outdoor drinking areas located within 10 metres of an outdoor sporting venue during a sporting event or training session.
 - (iv) Clubs found in breach of Regulation 1.18.2, may be subject to a fine in accordance with Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.

1.19. MEMBER PROTECTION

- 1.19.1.** No person subject to these Rules shall act towards or speak to any other person in a manner, or engage in conduct, which threatens, disparages, vilifies, discriminates against or insults another person on any basis, including but not limited to race, religion, colour, descent, national or ethnic origin, special ability or disability, or sexual orientation, preference or identity.

2. BHRDCA COMPETITIONS

2.1. COMPETITION MANAGEMENT

2.1.1. The BHRDCA is responsible for administering its Competitions and, subject to these Rules, the CoM may determine the Competition structure, playing formats, Grades, season dates, Team submission process, Finals formats, Finals eligibility criteria and the Player Points System.

2.1.2. The BHRDCA at its discretion will determine:

- (i) Competition Structure
- (ii) Competition formats
- (iii) Competition grades
- (iv) Season dates
- (v) Team Submission Process
- (vi) Finals formats
- (vii) Finals eligibility criteria
- (viii) Player Points System (PPS)

2.2. COMPETITION FORMATS

2.2.1. The BHRDCA may conduct the following Competition Formats for the 2026/27 season:

- (i) Two-Day Cricket
- (ii) One-Day Cricket
- (iii) Split Innings Cricket
- (iv) T20 Cricket
- (v) Modified Formats

2.3. COMPETITION POINTS

2.3.1. Match Points are allocated in accordance with the relevant Competition Rules:

- (i) Senior Competitions contain Senior Match Points.
- (ii) Junior Competitions contain Junior Match Points.

2.4. ABANDONED ROUNDS

2.4.1. The CoM shall be the sole determinant of whether a Round is declared an Abandoned or Cancelled Round. Match Points and any effect on the Match format shall then be determined under the applicable Senior or Junior Playing Conditions.

3. SENIOR COMPETITIONS

3.1. GRADES

3.1.1. The BHRDCA may structure Senior Competitions into:

- (i) Two-Day Grades
- (ii) One-Day Grades
- (iii) Split Innings Grades
- (iv) T20 Grades
- (v) Any other formats approved by BHRDCA.

3.1.2. The BHRDCA top four Senior Grades are as follows:

- (i) Ray McIntosh Shield
- (ii) Howard Wilson Shield
- (iii) Dorothy McIntosh Shield
- (iv) Peter White Shield

3.1.3. All other Grades are ranked alphabetically or numerically.

3.2. MATCH SCHEDULING

3.2.1. Senior matches are played on the allocated dates and times set by BHRDCA.

3.2.2. BHRDCA may introduce additional rules for matches played outside permitted conditions.

3.2.3. BHRDCA may reschedule matches due to:

- (i) Weather
- (ii) Ground Availability
- (iii) Extreme conditions
- (iv) Exceptional circumstances

3.3. MATCH POINTS

3.3.1. Match Points for Senior BHRDCA competitions are awarded as follows:

Result	Points
Outright win (leading on 1 st innings)	10
Outright win where first innings is tied	8
Outright tie (ahead on 1 st innings)	7
Outright win (behind on 1 st innings)	6
Outright tie (1 st innings tied)	5 each
1 st innings win	6
1 st innings win but lose outright	4
1 st innings tie	3 each
Outright tie (behind on 1 st innings)	3
Match abandoned / cancelled / drawn	3 each
Outright loss (1 st innings tie)	2

3.3.2. If no play occurs on any day and no first-innings result exists, the match shall be declared as a Draw.

3.3.3. Any round declared an Abandoned or Cancelled Round shall be at the discretion of the CoM.

3.3.4. Any round Abandoned or Cancelled due to Extreme Weather Conditions, shall be declared as a Draw, unless otherwise confirmed by the CoM.

3.3.5. A Team receiving a Forfeit shall be awarded the maximum Match Points obtained for the Round in that Grade, to a maximum of six (6) Match Points. If the Forfeit occurs in an Abandoned or Cancelled Round, the non-offending Team shall receive three (3) Match Points. The forfeiting Team shall receive zero (0) Match Points.

3.3.6. All Byes shall be awarded zero (0) Match Points.

- (i) In Grades where an unequal number of Byes occurs, the final Home & Away ladder shall be calculated using the ratio Match Points Obtained ÷ Matches Completed.

3.3.7. At the end of the regular season, Teams are ranked from highest to lowest based on the total number of Match Points obtained.

3.3.8. If at the end of the regular season one (1) or more Teams finish on the same number of points, their final position will be by the Team with the highest percentages as follows:

- (i) Batting Average – Runs Scored / Wickets Lost
- (ii) Bowling Average – Runs Conceded / Wickets Taken
- (iii) Batting Average / Bowling Average

3.3.9. A Team that declares its innings or has its innings compulsorily closed under the applicable playing conditions shall be deemed to have lost only those wickets that have actually fallen.

3.4. FORFEITS

3.4.1. A Club that is unable to field a Team on scheduled match day, must notify the BHRDCA Competition Administrator and the opposing Club by 12.00pm on the day prior to the scheduled match.

3.4.2. Failure to comply with regulation 3.4.1 may result in the Club being liable for a fine in accordance with Regulation 1.14 & the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.

3.4.3. All matches impacted by a Forfeit shall have their Match Points awarded as follows:

- (i) 6 points to the non-offending Team
- (ii) 3 points to the non-offending Team if the forfeit occurs during an Abandoned or Cancelled Round

3.5. READINESS FOR PLAY & TOSS

3.5.1. The ground must be fully prepared with matting, boundary markers (where applicable) and stumps being fixed 20 minutes prior to the start of play.

- (i) In the event of extreme weather conditions, bad light and/or ground conditions delaying the start of, or interrupting play, both Teams shall assist in making the ground ready for play.
- (ii) A Club that fails to assist in making the ground ready for play as required by this Regulation may be subject to the applicable sanction under Regulation 1.14 and Appendix 5.7.

3.5.2. The Umpire(s) shall gather both competing Captains and complete the coin toss no less than 20 minutes prior to the start of play, with the Captain winning the toss to immediately signify their intention to either bat or bowl first to the opposing Captain and Umpire(s).

- (i) In the event a Captain is not present at the coin toss, the Umpire(s) has discretion to award the coin toss to the opposing Captain.

3.5.3. Both Teams must be ready to commence play by the scheduled time. Any Team deemed in breach of causing a late start, may be subject to a fine in accordance with Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.

3.5.4. If play does not commence within 30 minutes of the scheduled time, the Umpire(s) may deem the match forfeited, with the offending Team being deemed to have forfeited the match and subject to fine in line with Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.

- (i) The non-offending Team impacted by the forfeit shall be awarded six (6) points.

3.6. DRINKS BREAKS

3.6.1. One Drinks Break is permitted at the mid-point of each session provided there has been no time lost in play during that session.

(i) 1.00pm Match – Drinks are permitted at 2.10pm and 4.50pm.

(ii) 1.30pm Match – Drinks are permitted at 2.30pm and 4.55pm.

3.6.2. Drinks Breaks may be adjusted with agreement of both Captains and/or the Umpire(s) if present.

3.6.3. On match days impacted by Extreme Weather Conditions, Drinks Break must be adhered to in line with the BHRDCA Extreme Weather Conditions Policy as per appendix 5.8.

3.7. MATCH-DAY REQUIREMENTS

3.7.1. Team Sheets

(i) Team Sheets for BHRDCA Senior Competitions must be completed in accordance with regulation 1.5.

(ii) Team Sheets must include:

- a. All Players
- b. Captain
- c. Wicketkeeper
- d. Substitute(s)

3.7.2. Results of Matches

(i) The Home Team must submit the information below onto PlayHQ following the conclusion of the match and by midnight that day:

- a. Full batting card
- b. Full bowling card
- c. Fielding statistics
- d. Match details
- e. Substitute fielders
- f. Replacement players
- g. Retirements

- (ii) The Away Team must complete the below by midnight two days following the conclusion of the match:
 - a. Confirm the match result
 - b. Enter all batting, bowling and fielding statistics
 - c. Ensure all data is correct
- (iii) Each club fielding a Team in a Shield Grade shall provide a scorer. Where no designated scorer is present, Captains must check and confirm the Match scores, Team Sheets and individual batting, bowling, fielding and wicketkeeping performances after each innings and at the end of each day's play.

3.7.3. Recording Innings Closures

- (i) A Team is recorded as ALL OUT when:
 - a. Ten (10) wickets fall, or;
 - b. Fewer than eleven (11) players bat and all but one are dismissed
- (ii) Retirements
 - a. 100 Retired Not Out (Split Innings)
 - b. 50 Retired Not Out (One-Day)
- (iii) Declarations
 - a. A Team that declares an innings under the applicable Playing Conditions shall be recorded with the wickets actually lost and the final score marked DECLARED.
- (iv) Compulsory Closures
 - a. A Team whose innings is compulsorily closed under the applicable Playing Conditions shall be recorded with the wickets actually lost and the final score marked COMPULSORY CLOSE.

3.7.4. Match Reports

- (i) A report of each match must be provided by such date and in such manner as directed by the CoM. If no play is possible in the time set aside for the match, or if a Team receives a Forfeit, a Team Sheet must be submitted and the relevant players shall be deemed to have played in the match for the purpose of all qualification and eligibility requirements.
 - a. No Team Receiving a Bye shall be permitted to enter a Team Sheet
 - b. No Team Forfeiting a Match shall be permitted to enter a Team Sheet
 - c. Any Team Forfeiting a Match after an infraction of these Rules (as determined by the CoM), shall not be permitted to enter a Team Sheet. E.g., Team A plays an ineligible player and the CoM determines an outcome that wards the match by forfeit to Team B.
- (ii) This shall result in the removal of Team A's Team Sheet and no qualification (match count, finals eligibility or playing achievement) for the players correctly named in Team A shall apply for this match.
- (iii) Team B shall be awarded the maximum of Six (6) Match Points for the Forfeit win.

3.7.5. Captains Reports

- (i) Both competing Captains must complete a Captains Report for each appointed Umpire within forty-eight (48) hours of the completion of the Match.

3.7.6. Infringements

- (i) Clubs may be subject to financial sanctions in accordance with Regulation 1.14 Schedule of Administration Fees for any breaches of Regulation 3.7.1, 3.7.2, 3.7.3 and or 3.7.4.

3.7.7. Protests & Disputes

- (i) Protests and/or Disputes resulting from a match must be submitted in writing by the Club President and/or Secretary to the BHRDCA Competition Administrator by 8pm on the Tuesday following the completion of the match.
- (ii) A deposit of \$200 must be lodged with any protest. This deposit will be forfeited if the BHRDCA determines the protest to be frivolous.
- (iii) The BHRDCA Competition Administrator will provide a copy of the protest to the opposing Club advising of a request for response within 48 hours of receipt of the protest.
- (iv) Protests will be reviewed and considered by a panel comprising the CoM and other applicable members.
- (v) All protest determinations are final and cannot be appealed.

3.8. PLAYER ELIGIBILITY

- 3.8.1.** A Player under twelve (12) years of age as at 1 September in the current season may participate in a Senior Competition only where the Player's Club has obtained written parental or guardian consent before the Player takes the field. The Club must provide that consent to the CoM on request.
- 3.8.2.** A Junior Player, being a Player under eighteen (18) years of age as at 1 September in the current season, may transfer freely between Cricket Victoria-based Junior Competitions subject to the applicable registration and permit requirements. The corresponding provision applies to women up to twenty (20) years of age in relation to participation in the appropriate Cricket Victoria-affiliated women's competitions.
- 3.8.3.** Regarding player movement between Senior Grades, players may only move one Club Grade from the Grade in which they last played.
- 3.8.4.** Only registered and eligible players may participate. A Team that fields an ineligible or unregistered Player may be deemed to have forfeited the Match, and the Player's performance and qualification from that Match may be declared null and void in accordance with these Rules.

3.9. PLAYER POINTS SYSTEM

- 3.9.1.** All teams competing in the Ray McIntosh Shield, Howard Wilson Shield, Dorothy McIntosh Shield and Peter White Shield are subject to the Player Points System in Appendix 5.6. A Team subject to the PPS must not exceed twenty (20) Player Points in a Match.

4.

4.1. SENIOR MEN'S - TWO-DAY MATCH RULES

4.1.1. Playing Hours

- (i) Two-day Matches shall be played in line with the below playing hours:

Grade	Playing Hours
80 Over Grades	1:00pm – 6:00pm
70 Over Grades	1:00pm – 5:30pm
64 Over Grades	1:00pm – 5:00pm

- (ii) An additional ten (10) minutes per change of innings per day is permitted.
- (iii) On non-daylight savings dates, play commences 30 minutes earlier and concludes 30 minutes earlier.

4.1.2. Extension of Playing Time

- (i) Play on Day One may be extended to recover time lost up to a maximum of 17 overs due to:
- Extreme conditions
 - Bad light
 - Exceptional circumstances
- (ii) Play on Day 2 may be extended by an amount equal to the time lost during the match, up to a maximum of 17 overs.
- (iii) Any unused extension from Day One may also be utilised on Day Two.
- (iv) Extension of playing time examples:

Day One Time Lost	Day One Extension	Overs Available on Day Two
No time lost	-	17 overs
21 minutes	6 overs	11 overs
28 minutes	8 overs	9 overs
49 minutes	14 overs	3 overs

4.1.3. Tea Interval

- (i) A 20-minute tea interval shall be taken at the completion of the over in process at 3:20pm (2:50pm non-daylight savings, unless:
- Nine (9) wickets are down, or twenty (20) runs or fewer are required.
 - An innings is completed after 2:50pm (2:20pm) or play is stopped after that time due to extreme conditions, bad light or exceptional circumstances.
 - A wicket falls within three (3) minutes of the scheduled tea interval, unless regulation 3.10.3.(i).a applies.

- d. Play commences at or after 2:50pm (2:20pm), in which case no tea break shall be taken.

4.1.4. Overs in a Day

- (i) The maximum overs to be bowled in a day's play unless reduced under other provisions shall be:

Match Type	Maximum Overs
Two-Day Match (Shield & 80 over Grades)	80 overs
Two-Day Match (70 over grades)	70 overs
Two-Day Match (64 over grades)	64 overs
One Day Grades	70 overs
Split Innings Grades	64 overs

- (ii) Prior to the commencement of play after any break, the umpire(s) shall advise both captains of the number of overs remaining.
- (iii) If required, play shall continue beyond the scheduled finish time until the required overs have been completed.

4.1.5. Follow-on

- (i) A Team which bats first may require the opposing Team to follow-on should they obtain a lead of at least:
- 80 runs or more in standard Two-Day Grades; or
 - 60 runs or more in Reduced Over Grades
- (ii) The Captain must advise both the Umpire(s) and opposing Team Captain of their intention to enforce the follow-on:
- (iii) Where the innings of the Team batting second is completed at the close on play on Day One, the opposing Captain must be advised of a follow-on request no later than 15 minutes prior to the scheduled start of play on Day Two.
- Failure to comply with regulation 3.10.5.(iii) shall force the follow-on to be effective from the scheduled start of play.

4.1.6. Declaration

- (i) The Captain of the Team batting may declare an innings closed at any time while the ball is dead.
- (ii) The Captain of the Team batting must notify the Umpire(s) and opposing Captain of their intention to declare.
- (iii) If no declaration is made at the conclusion of Day One, any overnight declaration must be advised at least 15 minutes prior to the scheduled start of play on Day Two.
 - a. Failure to comply with regulation 3.10.6.(iii), will result in the declaration taking effect from the scheduled start of play.

4.1.7. Reduction in Overs

- (i) Where playing time is lost due to any of the below reasons, the overs shall be reduced at the rate of one (1) over for every 3 ½ minutes of lost playing time.
 - a. Extreme conditions;
 - b. Bad light; or
 - c. Exceptional circumstances which in the opinion of the Umpire(s) / Captains were beyond the control of either Team.
- (ii) Where the time lost is sixty (60) minutes or less and the time lost is able to be made up under regulation 3.10.2, there shall be no reduction in overs.
- (iii) Where the time lost exceeds sixty (60) minutes and the time is able to be made up under regulation 3.10.2, only the time in excess of sixty (60) minutes shall be used when calculating the reduction.

4.1.8. Slow Over Rate

- (i) Where appointed, the Umpire(s) shall record:
 - a. The start and finish time;
 - b. The number of overs bowled after the scheduled finishing time; and
 - c. The allocation of any Slow Over Rate penalties.
- (ii) Penalties shall be applied in accordance with Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.
- (iii) Where the required overs are not bowled within the scheduled time, Umpire(s) and Captains (where Umpires are not present) are to show appropriate leniency where delays are attributed to any of the below reasons:
 - a. Weather;
 - b. Lost balls;
 - c. Player injury;
 - d. Excessive boundary scoring;
 - e. Replacement of bails; or

f. Other circumstances

- (iv) No matter the penalties or potential of, all scheduled overs are to be completed where conditions permit, unless a first innings result has already been achieved.

4.1.9. Compulsory Closure

- (i) A Compulsory Closure occurs where a full day's play is completed on Day One.
- (ii) Innings of the Team Batting first shall be Compulsory Closed when:
 - a. The required overs have been bowled for the day;
 - b. The number of completed overs includes the final over of the innings, even if a full six (6) fair deliveries may not have been bowled in the over;
 - c. Play has been interrupted by extreme conditions, bad light, or exceptional circumstances and play has been extended under regulation 3.10.2.
- (iii) Innings of the Team Batting second shall commence on Day Two when:
 - a. The first Team has received its full allocation of 80 overs, 70 overs, or 64 overs as applicable.
- (iv) Result of the Match:
 - a. The match shall be decided by the number of runs scored in each first innings irrespective of wickets lost, unless an outright result was achieved.

4.1.10. Non-Compulsory Closure

- (i) A Non-Compulsory Closure occurs where the innings of the Team batting first is completed or declared.
- (ii) Non-Compulsory Closure conditions apply when:
 - a. The innings of the Team batting first is completed on the first day; or
 - b. The Team batting first declares its innings closed; or
 - c. The first innings of both Teams is completed; or
 - d. More than sixty (60) minutes of playing time is lost during the match

4.1.11. First Innings Completed on Day One

- (i) Where the innings of the Team batting first is completed on Day One, the following will occur:
 - a. The Team batting second shall receive the balance of the scheduled overs remaining on Day one, along with the full allocation of overs on Day Two.
 - b. Exception to regulation 3.10.11(i).a is when the remaining balance coincides with a tea break, extreme conditions, bad light or exceptional circumstances causing a delay of more than sixty (60) minutes.

Example:

First Team is dismissed in the 72nd over, the second Team is entitled to bat 88 overs as the balance of the 160 overs left to be bowled in the match.

- (ii) If the Team batting first declares its innings closed on Day One, a full day's play must take place.
- (iii) Unless dismissed beforehand, the total number of overs received by the Team batting second shall be no less than those received by the Team batting first, play shall continue to this end on the second day beyond the scheduled finishing time without penalty.

4.1.12. First Innings of Both Teams Completed

- (i) Where the first innings of both Teams are completed, the following will occur:
 - a. Play continues for the remaining scheduled over; or
 - b. The match concludes immediately upon an outright decision being reached

4.1.13. Cessation of Play

- (i) If a first innings result has been reached and there is no likelihood of any further result, play will continue until Tea is called, after which the Captains by agreement may request the Umpire(s) to draw stumps at any time after 4:30pm (4:00pm non-daylight saving time) on the second day. Should the Captains not agree, play will continue.

4.1.14. Loss of More Than Sixty (60) Minutes Playing Time in a Match

- (i) Where more than sixty (60) minutes of playing time is lost in a match, the Team batting first is entitled to bat into the second day up to an innings maximum of 80, 70 or 64 overs.
- (ii) The second Team is then entitled to receive the balance of the overs on the second day.

4.1.15. Second Innings

- (i) If sufficient time remains after completion of both first innings, a new innings shall commence and play shall continue until the remaining overs have been bowled.

4.1.16. Result of Match

- (i) Provided the Team batting second has received at least the same number of overs as the Team batting first, the winner shall be the Team scoring the greater number of runs in the first innings, unless an outright result is achieved.
- (ii) Where the Team batting second has not received at least the same number of overs in its first innings, as the Team batting first (having not been dismissed, nor having passed the score beforehand), the match shall be declared a Draw.

4.1.17. Player Eligibility (Two-Day Grades)

- (i) For Two-Day Grade matches, a Team may list twelve (12) or thirteen (13) registered and eligible Players on the Team Sheet, which any combination of eleven (11) Players may bat, bowl and field on either day.
- (ii) Only eleven (11) Players may be on the field of play at any one time.

- (iii) Only ten (10) wickets may fall in an innings per normal playing conditions.
- (iv) Should a second innings be undertaken, all players are eligible to be named in any second batting innings subject to regulation 3.10.16.(i).
- (v) Any 12th or 13th player must be eligible for selection in that grade and cannot be selected for any other Team their Club may field on their 'non-playing' week.
- (vi) A Team that breaches this Regulation may be subject to the applicable sanction for an ineligible Player under Regulation 1.14 and Appendix 5.7.

4.1.18. Team Sheets

- (i) All listed Players must be entered onto PlayHQ and also be recorded in both scorebooks.
- (ii) A Player not recorded on both PlayHQ and the Match scorebook as required by these Rules may be deemed ineligible and the Match may be excluded from that Player's Finals qualification.
- (iii) Teams are not required to select a 12th or 13th player, Teams may elect to play with eleven (11) players.
- (iv) Teams are not required to nominate any non-batter or non-bowler among their listed players.

4.1.19. No Play or Cancellation of Play

- (i) Where on Day One of a scheduled Two-Day game less than 50% of the scheduled overs have been completed or play has not commenced by 3:40pm (3:10pm non-daylight savings), play shall be cancelled and scores are declared null and void.
- (ii) The match shall then be played as a One-Day match under regulation 3.11 along with a new toss taking place and new teams can be named.
- (iii) Where 50% or more of the scheduled Two-Day matches within the format (eg 80, 70, 64 over grades and split innings grades) are cancelled under regulation 3.10.18.(i), the CoM shall determine the rescheduled nature of any such matches as One-Day games.
- (iv) Regulation 3.10.18.(iii) does not apply to BHRDCA Finals matches.

4.1.20. Last Over of Days Play

- (i) Any over commenced after scheduled finishing time shall be completed, notwithstanding the fall of wicket(s) during that over.

4.1.21. Cessation of Play

- (i) Where a first innings result has been reached and there is no likelihood of any further result, the Captains by agreement may request the Umpire(s) to draw stumps at any time after 4:30pm (4:00pm non-daylight savings time) on the second day.

4.1.22. Reduced Overs Restrictions (Non-Split Innings Format – currently 64 Over Matches)

- (i) A bowler may bowl a maximum of 14 overs in the first 64 overs of an innings, while no restrictions apply for any second innings.

- (ii) A batter who reached 100 runs must retire on the ball on which they reach 100 and they shall be deemed Retired Not Out and cannot return to bat in that innings (i.e., the Teams innings is deemed Compulsory Closed once all wickets have been lost including any 100 run retirements).

4.1.23. Fast Short-Pitches Deliveries

- (i) A bowler is permitted a maximum of two (2) fast short-pitched deliveries per over.
- (ii) A fast short-pitched delivery is defined as one which passes or would have passed between the shoulder and head height of the striker at the popping crease in their normal batting stance.
- (iii) If a third fast short-pitched delivery is bowled in the same over, the umpire shall call and signal a No Ball and caution the bowler.
- (iv) If the bowler is cautioned for the same offence a second time in the same innings, the Umpire shall issue a final warning.
- (v) If the bowler is cautioned for the same offence a third time in the same innings, the Umpire shall direct the fielding Captain to suspend the bowler immediately. The bowler shall not be permitted to bowl again in the innings, with another bowler eligible to complete an over if required.

4.1.24. Fast Short-Pitches Deliveries Above Head Height

- (i) Any short-pitched ball which passes or would have passed above head height of the striker at the popping crease in their normal batting stance, is to be called a No Ball.

4.2. SENIOR MEN'S - ONE-DAY MATCH RULES

4.2.1. Playing Hours

- (i) One-day Matches shall be played in line with the below playing hours:

Grade	Playing Hours
80 Over Grades	12:30pm – 5:30pm
70 Over Grades	12:30pm – 5:00pm
64 Over Grades	12:30pm – 4:30pm

- (ii) An additional ten (10) minutes per change of innings per day is permitted.
- (iii) On non-daylight savings dates, play commences 30 minutes earlier and concludes 30 minutes earlier.

4.2.2. Tea Interval

- (i) A 20-minute tea interval shall be taken at the completion of the first innings.
- (ii) The change of innings is included in the time allowed for the tea interval.
- (iii) Where tea is taken prior to the completion of the first innings due to extreme weather or other exceptional circumstances, play shall resume to complete the first innings and the scheduled time is extended by ten (10) minutes to complement the change of innings. This shall be in addition to any time extended for interrupted playing time.

4.2.3. Overs in a Day

- (i) The maximum overs to be bowled in a day's play per innings unless reduced under other provisions shall be:

Match Type	Maximum Overs
One Day Open	35 overs
Split Innings	32 overs

- (ii) Prior to the commencement of play after any break, the umpire(s) shall advise both captains of the number of overs remaining.
- (iii) If required, play shall continue beyond the scheduled finish time until the required overs have been completed.
- a. At the start of the first over commenced after the specified finishing time.

4.2.4. Late Start

- (i) Where the start of play is delayed due to extreme conditions, bad light or exceptional circumstances, playing time is equally divided, allowing three and a half minutes per over to ascertain the number of overs bowled.
- (ii) Daylight Savings – If the match has not commenced by 3:15pm (80 overs), 3:05pm (70 overs) and/or 2:45pm (64 overs), then play is abandoned.
- (iii) Non-Daylight Savings – If the match has not commenced by 2:45pm (80 overs), 2:35pm (70 overs) and or 2:15pm (64 overs), the play is abandoned.
- (iv) For interrupted play, refer to regulation 3.11.5.

4.2.5. Interruptions to Play

- (i) Where play is interrupted due to extreme conditions, bad light or exceptional circumstances, playing time may be extended by the amount of time lost, up to a maximum of thirty (30) minutes beyond the scheduled finishing time.
- (ii) Where more than thirty (30) minutes of playing time has been lost in aggregate of both innings, the scheduled number of overs to be bowled shall be reduced by one over for every three and a half (3 ½) minutes lost beyond the initial thirty (30) minutes.
- (iii) The innings of the Team batting first shall not exceed their Grades maximum overs or any reduced allocation determined under regulation 3.11.6.
- (iv) Any reduction of overs once play has commenced shall reduce the innings of the Team batting second. The Umpire(s) shall notify the scorers of the number of overs to be bowled in each innings.

4.2.6. Duckworth-Lewis-Stern (DLS)

- (i) The **Cricket Victoria DLS Calculator** shall be used to determine revised targets and Match results in interrupted One-Day Matches in the following Grades:
 - Ray McIntosh Shield;
 - Howard Wilson Shield;
 - Dorothy McIntosh Shield;
 - Peter White Shield;
 - Senior T20 and;
 - Under 18's
- (ii) DLS shall apply where the number of overs available to either Team is reduced due to an interruption after the commencement of the Match.
- (iii) Where DLS is required, the revised target shall be calculated using the Cricket Victoria DLS Calculator.
- (iv) The Home Club shall provide reasonable access to an internet-enabled device where required to complete the DLS calculation.
- (v) The appointed Umpires along with the scorers shall be responsible for the application of DLS and for advising both Captains and scorers of any revised target.
- (vi) Where a Match is completed using DLS, the result shall be recorded in accordance with the revised target determined by the DLS calculation.

4.2.7. Slow Over Rate

- (i) Where appointed, the Umpire(s) shall record:
 - a. The start and finish time;
 - b. The number of overs bowled after the scheduled finishing time; and
 - c. The allocation of any Slow Over Rate penalties.
- (ii) Penalties shall be applied in accordance with Regulation 1.14, Appendix 5.7 and the Senior Slow Over Rate provisions in these Rules.
- (iii) Where the required overs are not bowled within the scheduled time, Umpire(s) and Captains (where Umpires are not present) are to show appropriate leniency where delays are attributed to any of the below reasons:
 - a. Weather;
 - b. Lost balls;
 - c. Player injury;
 - d. Excessive boundary scoring;
 - e. Replacement of bails; or
 - f. Other circumstances
- (iv) No matter the penalties or potential of, all scheduled overs are to be completed where conditions permit, unless a first innings result has already been achieved.

4.2.8. Compulsory Closure

- (i) If the Team batting first has not completed its innings, the innings shall be Compulsory Closed on the completion of 35 overs and/or 32 overs relative to the Grade, or such lesser number of overs as determined under regulation 3.11.5.
- (ii) The Team batting second, if not dismissed is entitled to bat for 35 overs and/or 32 overs relative to the Grade, unless a result is achieved beforehand, where the match must then end.

4.2.9. Dismissal

- (i) Where the Team batting first is dismissed prior to the completion of their allocated overs, the Team batting second is entitled to bat for their maximum allocated overs, unless a result is achieved beforehand, where the match must then end. The Team batting second does not receive the additional overs from the Team batting firsts innings.

4.2.10. Result of Match

- (i) The Team which scores the greater number of runs irrespective of wickets lost is declared the winner at the end of the day's play.
- (ii) In Shield grades, in weather affected matches, the DLS system will be used to determine a result, providing each side receives a minimum of 20 overs each. If both sides, do not receive 20 overs, the match will be determined a draw.
- (iii) In Non-Shield grades where the Team batting second does not receive the same number of overs as the Team batting first, and remains undischarged without passing the first Team's score, the match is declared a draw.
- (iv) In order to receive a positive result, the Team batting first may wish to declare its innings closed, which it can at any time to allow the side batting second to receive the same number of overs.

4.2.11. Player Eligibility (One-Day Grades)

- (i) For One-Day Grade matches, a Team may list twelve (12) registered and eligible Players on the Team Sheet, which any combination of eleven (11) Players may bat, bowl and field on either day.
- (ii) Only eleven (11) Players may be on the field of play at any one time.
- (iii) Only ten (10) wickets may fall in an innings per normal playing conditions.
- (iv) Any 12th player must be eligible for selection in that grade and cannot be selected for any other Team their Club may field on their 'non-playing' week.
- (v) Any Team found in breach of regulation 3.11.11, may be subject to penalties under Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.

4.2.12. Team Sheets

- (i) All listed Players must be entered onto PlayHQ and also be recorded in both scorebooks.
- (ii) Players not listed in the scorebook and on PlayHQ, may be deemed ineligible and not counted as a game towards finals qualification.
- (iii) Teams are not required to select a 12th or player and may elect to play with eleven (11) players.

- (iv) Teams are not required to nominate any non-batter or non-bowler among their listed players.

4.2.13. No Play or Cancellation of Play

- (i) Where less than 50% of the scheduled overs have been completed or play has not commenced by 3:40pm (3:10pm non-daylight savings), play shall be cancelled and scores are declared null and void.

4.2.14. Last Over of Days Play

- (i) Any over commenced after scheduled finishing time shall be completed, notwithstanding the fall of wicket(s) during that over.

4.2.15. Bowling Restrictions – One-Day Matches in Two-Day Grade Competitions

- (i) Where a One-Day match is played within a Two-Day Grade Competition, a minimum of five (5) bowlers shall be used where Non-Compulsory Closure conditions apply, with the maximum number of overs to be bowled by any bowler being limited to:
 - a. Two-Day Grades (80 Overs) – Eight (8) Overs
 - b. Two-Day Grades (70 Overs) – Seven (7) Overs
 - c. Two-Day Grades (64 Overs) – Seven (7) Overs
- (ii) Where the number of overs in an innings is reduced under the One-Day Late Start or Interruptions provisions, no bowler may bowl more than twenty per cent (20%) of the scheduled overs in that innings.
- (iii) Where the calculation produces a fraction, the permitted maximum shall be rounded up for as many bowlers as necessary to absorb the balance in whole overs.

4.2.16. Bowling Restrictions – One-Day Grade Competitions

- (i) Where the number of overs in an innings is reduced under the One-Day Late Start or Interruptions provisions, no bowler may bowl more than twenty per cent (20%) of the scheduled overs in that innings.
- (ii) Where the calculation produces a fraction, the permitted maximum shall be rounded up for as many bowlers as necessary to absorb the balance in whole overs.

4.2.17. Batting Restrictions – One-Day Grades & 64 Over Two-Day Grade Competitions

- (i) A batter who reaches 50 runs must retire on the ball on which they reach 50 and they shall be deemed Retired Not Out and cannot return to bat in that innings (i.e. the innings is deemed to be compulsory closed once 10 wickets have been lost including any retirements.)

4.2.18. Fast Short-Pitches Deliveries

- (i) A bowler is permitted a maximum of one (1) fast short-pitched delivery per over.
- (ii) A fast short-pitched delivery is defined as one which passes or would have passed between the shoulder and head height of the striker at the popping crease in their normal batting stance.
- (iii) If a second fast short-pitched delivery is bowled in the same over, the umpire shall call and signal a No Ball and caution the bowler.

- (iv) If the bowler is cautioned for the same offence a second time in the same innings, the Umpire shall issue a final warning.
- (v) If the bowler is cautioned for the same offence a third time in the same innings, the Umpire shall direct the fielding Captain to suspend the bowler immediately. The bowler shall not be permitted to bowl again in the innings, with another bowler eligible to complete an over if required.

4.2.19. Fast Short-Pitches Deliveries Above Head Height

- (i) Any short-pitched ball which passes or would have passed above head height of the striker at the popping crease in their normal batting stance, is to be called a No Ball.

4.2.20. No Ball

- (i) In 80 Over Grades, only any ball called a No Ball by either the controlling or square leg Umpire shall result in a 'Free Hit' from the next legitimate ball bowled.

4.2.21. Fielding Restrictions

- a) Fielding restrictions apply to all One-Day Matches. A restricted area shall be marked by two semi-circles with a radius of 27.5 metres measured from the centre stump at each end and joined by two straight lines parallel to the pitch.
- b) The limits of the restricted area must be clearly marked by a white line or flat discs. Where discs are used, at least thirty (30) must be used, spaced approximately seven (7) metres apart, including a disc at each extremity of the semi-circles.
- c) During the initial fielding-restriction period, no more than two (2) fielders may be positioned outside the restricted area. The initial period is eight (8) overs in a 40-over innings and seven (7) overs in the applicable shorter One-Day innings.
- d) Where the innings is reduced, the initial restriction period is twenty per cent (20%) of the scheduled overs, rounded up to the next whole over where required.
- e) For the remainder of the innings, no more than five (5) fielders may be positioned outside the restricted area.
- f) If the fielding Team breaches the applicable restriction at the time the ball is bowled, the Umpire shall call and signal No Ball.

4.3. SPLIT INNINGS MATCH RULES

4.3.1. These Playing Conditions apply to all Senior Two-Day Competitions designated by the CoM as Split Innings Competitions.

4.3.2. Bowling Restrictions

- (i) A bowler is permitted to bowl a maximum of 14 overs in an innings.
- (ii) No bowler may bowl more than 7 overs during a 32-over split session.
- (iii) Once the first 64 overs of an innings have been completed, no bowling restrictions apply.

4.3.3. Batting Restrictions

- (i) A batter who reaches 100 runs in a Two-Day Match (50 runs in a One-Day Match) shall be deemed to be Retired Not Out and must not return to bat in that innings.

4.3.4. Team Composition

- (i) A Team may nominate up to 13 registered players of which any combination of 11 players can bat, bowl and field.
- (ii) There may only be 11 players on the field at any time.
- (iii) A maximum of 10 wickets may fall in an innings as per normal playing conditions.

4.3.5. Team Sheets

- (i) All 13 players must be entered into PlayHQ prior to the match, while also being recorded in both scorebooks.

- (ii) Players not recorded on PlayHQ, along with the scorebooks, will not have those match(es) counted towards finals qualification.

4.3.6. Second Innings

- (i) Should a second innings be played;
 - a. Any of the nominated 13 players may bat (subject to only 11 batting and a maximum of 10 wickets lost).
 - b. Any of the nominated 13 players may bowl.
 - c. If a bowler exceeds the maximum number of overs permitted, any deliveries bowled in excess of the permitted limit are null and void, with the over needing to be completed by another eligible bowler.

4.4. SENIOR FINALS

4.4.1. All BHRDCA Senior Competitions will conclude with a Finals Series, played as per the below format:

- (i) The Teams finishing in 1st, 2nd, 3rd & 4th position will qualify for finals.
- (ii) Semi Final 1 – Team 1 vs Team 4
- (iii) Semi Final 2 – Team 2 vs Team 3
- (iv) The winners of the Semi Final will playoff in the Grand Final
- (v) If a Semi Final concludes without at least a first innings result being achieved, the Team that finished in the higher position on the ladder at the end of the Home & Away Season will be declared the winner.
- (vi) The winner of the Grand Final will be crowned 2026/27 Season Premiers for their respective Grade.
- (vii) If a Grand Final concludes without at least a first innings result, the premiership will be shared between the two Teams.

4.4.2. Substitute players can be used in finals matches only if:

- (i) The Team Manager / Coach declares the substitution to the appointed Umpire, or where no Umpire is present, to the opposing Captain.
- (ii) The substitute player is registered on PlayHQ and is eligible to play.
- (iii) Substitutes are noted on the Team Sheet and scorecard, if allowed.

4.4.3. Player Eligibility:

- (i) A Player must satisfy the following minimum Home & Away Match qualification for the relevant Grade to be eligible to participate in that Team's Finals Series:

Grade	Minimum matches to qualify
Shield Grades	5 matches
80 Over Grades	5 matches
70 Over Grades	4 matches
64 Over Grades	4 matches
One Day Grades	6 matches
Split Innings Grades	4 matches

- (ii) Finals qualification is determined by the minimum Match requirements in Regulation 3.13.3. A Player may only drop one Club Grade from the Grade in which they last played.

5. JUNIOR COMPETITIONS

5.1. MANAGEMENT OF TEAMS

- 5.1.1.** The Each Club must appoint a Junior Coordinator who acts as the primary contact for liaison and communication with BHRDCA and other Clubs on Junior Competition matters.
- 5.1.2.** Each Junior Team must have a Team Manager and/or Coach responsible for the conduct and safety of Players and for ensuring that Matches are played in the proper spirit of the game.
- 5.1.3.** Unless an Umpire or official BHRDCA representative is appointed, the Team Managers/Coaches are responsible for decisions regarding the conduct of the Match.
- 5.1.4.** The Junior Coordinator must ensure that Team Managers/Coaches have read and understood these Rules and have access to them on Match days.
- 5.1.5.** Each Club must have at least one person accredited as a Level 1 Coach through Cricket Australia, or holding an equivalent recognised coaching accreditation, for its Junior Teams.
- 5.1.6.** Before the first Round, each Club must ensure that the names and contact details of its Junior Coordinator, Team Managers and nominated accredited Coach are current in the Competition Management System or otherwise provided to BHRDCA as directed.

5.2. AGE GROUPS

- 5.2.1.** The BHRDCA may structure Junior Competitions into the age groups below:

- (i) Under 18
- (ii) Under 16
- (iii) Under 14
- (iv) Under 12
- (v) Fast 9's
- (vi) Super 7's

5.3. GRADES & FORMATS

- 5.3.1.** The BHRDCA may structure Junior Competitions into:

- (i) Two-Day Grades
- (ii) One-Day Grades
- (iii) Split Innings Grades
- (iv) Any other formats approved by BHRDCA.

5.4. MATCH SCHEDULING

5.4.1. Junior matches are played on the allocated dates and times set by BHRDCA.

5.4.2. BHRDCA may introduce additional rules for matches played outside permitted conditions.

5.4.3. BHRDCA may reschedule matches due to:

- (i) Weather
- (ii) Ground Availability
- (iii) Extreme conditions
- (iv) Exceptional circumstances

5.5. MATCH POINTS

5.5.1. Match Points for Junior BHRDCA competitions are awarded as follows:

Result	Points
1 st Innings Win	6
1 st Innings Tie	3 each
Draw	3 each
Forfeit	6
Bye	0
Abandoned	3 each

5.5.2. If no play occurs on any day and no first-innings result exists, the match shall be declared as a Draw.

5.5.3. Any round declared an Abandoned or Cancelled Round shall be at the discretion of the CoM.

5.5.4. Any round Abandoned or Cancelled due to Extreme Weather Conditions, shall be declared as a Draw, unless otherwise confirmed by the CoM.

5.5.5. All Byes shall be awarded zero (0) Match Points.

- (i) In Grades where an unequal number of Byes occur, that Grades ladder at the end of the regular season shall be calculated by Match Points Obtained / Match Completed to determine each Teams Points Average.

5.5.6. At the end of the regular season, Teams are ranked from highest to lowest based on the total number of Match Points obtained.

5.5.7. If at the end of the regular season one (1) or more Teams finish on the same number of points, their final position will be by the Team with the highest percentages as follows:

- (i) Batting Average – Runs Scored / Wickets Lost
- (ii) Bowling Average – Runs Conceded / Wickets Taken
- (iii) Batting Average / Bowling Average

5.5.8. There is no opportunity for outright points in Junior Grades. Second innings may be played only if both Teams agree to enable more participation.

5.6. FORFEITS

- 5.6.1. A Club that is unable to field a Team on scheduled match day, must notify the BHRDCA Competition Administrator and the opposing Clubs Junior Coordinator by 8.00pm on the day prior to the scheduled match.
- 5.6.2. Failure to comply with regulation 5.5.1 may result in the Club being liable for a fine in accordance with Regulation 1.14 & the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.
- 5.6.3. All matches impacted by a Forfeit shall have their Match Points awarded as follows:
 - (i) 6 points to the non-offending Team
 - (ii) 3 points to the non-offending Team if the forfeit occurs during an Abandoned or Cancelled Round

Example: In a normal Round a non-offending Junior Team receives six (6) Match Points for a Forfeit. If the specific applicable rule awards different points because the Round is declared Abandoned/Cancelled, that specific Round rule applies. The forfeiting Team receives no Match Points.

5.7. READINESS FOR PLAY & TOSS

- 5.7.1. The ground must be fully prepared with matting, boundary markers (where applicable) and stumps being fixed 20 minutes prior to the start of play.
 - (i) In the event of extreme weather conditions, bad light and/or ground conditions delaying the start of, or interrupting play, both Teams shall assist in making the ground ready for play.
 - (ii) Any Club failing to comply with regulation 4.7.1. may be subject to a fine in accordance with Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.
- 5.7.2. The Umpire(s) shall gather both competing Captains and complete the coin toss no less than 20 minutes prior to the start of play, with the Captain winning the toss to immediately signify their intention to either bat or bowl first to the opposing Captain and Umpire(s).
 - (ii) In the event a Captain is not present at the coin toss, the Umpire(s) has discretion to award the coin toss to the opposing Captain.
- 5.7.3. Both Teams must be ready to commence play by the scheduled time.
- 5.7.4. Any Team that causes a late start may be subject to a fine in line with Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.
- 5.7.5. If play does not commence within 30 minutes of the scheduled time, the Umpire(s) may deem the match forfeited, with the offending Team being deemed to have forfeited the match and subject to fine in line with Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.
 - (ii) The non-offending Team impacted by the forfeit shall be awarded six (6) points.

5.8. INTERVALS BETWEEN INNINGS & DRINKS BREAKS

- 5.8.1.** There shall be a maximum of a ten (10) minute interval between innings in all Junior matches.
- 5.8.2.** Unless there has been an interval between innings less than fifteen (15) minutes prior, a five (5) minute maximum drinks break shall be taken at the completion of the over in progress:
- (i) 8.30am Match – Drinks are permitted at 10.00am or at the completion of the 25th over (whichever occurs first).
 - (ii) Twilight Match starting at 4.45pm/5.00pm – Drinks are permitted at 6.15pm or at the 25th over (whichever occurs first).
- 5.8.3.** On match days impacted by Extreme Weather Conditions, Drinks Break must be adhered to in line with the BHRDCA Extreme Weather Conditions Policy as per appendix 5.8.
- 5.8.4.** If a wicket falls during the last over before a scheduled drinks break, the drinks break is to be taken immediately.

5.9. MATCH-DAY REQUIREMENTS

5.9.1. Team Sheets

- (i) Team Sheets for BHRDCA Junior Competitions must be completed in accordance with regulation 1.5.
- (ii) Team Sheets must include:
 - a. All Players
 - b. Captain
 - c. Wicketkeeper
 - d. Substitute(s)

5.9.2. Results of Matches

- (i) The Home Team must submit the information below onto PlayHQ following the conclusion of the match and by 8:00pm on Sunday following the conclusion of the match:
 - a. Full batting card
 - b. Full bowling card
 - c. Fielding statistics
 - d. Match details
 - e. Substitute fielders
 - f. Replacement players
 - g. Retirements

- (ii) The Away Team must complete the below by 8:00pm on Monday following the conclusion of the match:
 - a. Confirm the match result
 - b. Enter all batting, bowling and fielding statistics
 - c. Ensure all data is correct

5.9.3. Incomplete Result Entry Penalty:

- (i) A Club may be fined if any Junior Competition match remains incomplete on PlayHQ by 4:00pm on the Monday after the conclusion of the match.
- (ii) Upon 72 hours passing post the conclusion of the match, the match will be locked on PlayHQ and the Club will be required to contact the BHRDCA Competition Administrator to unlock the game.

5.9.4. Protests & Disputes

- (i) All protests for Junior Competitions must be:
 - a. Submitted via email by a Club Administrator to the BHRDCA Competition Administrator by 8.00pm on Tuesday following the completion of the match.
 - b. The email must be signed by the Clubs Junior Coordinator along with the Club President or Secretary.
- (ii) A deposit of \$100 must be lodged with any protest. This deposit will be forfeited if the BHRDCA determines the protest to be frivolous.
- (iii) The BHRDCA Competition Administrator will provide a copy of the protest to the opposing Club advising of a request for response with 48 hours of receipt of the protest.
- (iv) Protests will be reviewed and considered by a panel comprising of the CoM and other applicable members.
- (v) All protest determinations are final and cannot be appealed.

5.9.5. Number of Players

- (i) A Junior Team must have at least seven (7) Players to commence a Match.
- (ii) There is no maximum number of Players in a Junior Team except where a specific Grade, including Under 18, has a maximum under these Rules.
- (iii) Where a Team has more than fifteen (15) Players, the Club should make arrangements for Players to participate with another Club on a permanent or rotational basis or combine with another Club to form an amalgamated Team, subject to BHRDCA approval.
- (iv) Where a fielding Team has only seven (7), eight (8) or nine (9) Players, the opposition must provide sufficient Substitute fielders to allow the fielding Team to have ten (10) fielders.

5.9.6. Match Balls (Junior)

- (i) Friday Twilight Under 12 and Under 14 Grades must use a BHRDCA-approved 142g two-piece pink leather ball.
- (ii) Friday Twilight Under 16 and Under 18 Grades must use a BHRDCA-approved 156g two-piece pink leather ball.
- (iii) A new approved pink leather ball must be used at the start of each Team's first innings. A used approved pink leather ball may be used for a second innings.

5.9.7. Fitness Of Conditions / Boundaries / Wicket Lengths

- (i) A ground is unfit for play where it is wet or slippery to the extent that bowlers cannot obtain a reasonable foothold, fielders cannot move freely, or batters cannot play their strokes or run between the wickets. Play must not be delayed or suspended solely because grass or the ball is wet or slippery.
- (ii) Where an official Umpire is appointed, the Umpire is solely responsible for determining whether conditions are fit to commence, resume or continue play. Where no official Umpire is appointed, the Team Managers/Coaches are responsible for that decision.
- (iii) If sixty (60) minutes or less is lost because of extreme conditions, play must not be called off unless both Team Managers/Coaches agree. If more than sixty (60) minutes is lost, either Team Manager/Coach may call off play. Appendix 5.8 must be observed at all times.
- (iv) If fewer than ten (10) overs are bowled on Day One of a Two-Day Match, unless Team A has been dismissed, Day One is cancelled and the Match is played as a One-Day Match on the following playing day.
- (v) Junior boundaries are: Under 14, Under 16 and Under 18 — 60 metres; Under 12 and Fast 9's — 45 metres; Super 7's — 40 metres, where oval dimensions allow. The boundary must be marked at least 2.74 metres (3 yards) in front of any fixed or immovable object.
- (vi) Artificial lighting must not be used to augment natural light when natural light falls below the expected playing standard.
- (vii) Wicket length is 18.1 metres for Under 12 and 20.1 metres for Under 14, Under 16 and Under 18.

5.10. PLAYER ELIGIBILITY

5.10.1. Age Eligibility

- (i) A male Player must be younger than the age limit for the Team as at 1 September preceding the start of the season.
- (ii) A female Player may be up to two (2) years older than the age limit for the Team as at 1 September.
- (iii) A Player must participate in the youngest age group for which they are eligible unless the Player's parent or guardian provides written permission allowing the Player to participate in an older age group.
- (iv) The CoM may, in special circumstances, approve a Player to participate in a younger age group on a case-by-case basis following a written request from the Player's Club and parent/guardian supported by relevant documentation.
- (v) A Player must not participate in a Team below their age group unless a valid dispensation has been approved by the CoM. A dispensation request must be submitted at least forty-eight (48) hours before the Match using the prescribed Junior Dispensation process.

5.10.2. Registration Requirements

- (i) All Junior Players must be registered on PlayHQ before participating in a Match, except for a permitted Fill-In Player under this Regulation. A Junior registration must include the information required by BHRDCA, including the Player's full name, correct date of birth and required contact details.
- (ii) A Club may use a Fill-In Player only once per season. The Fill-In Player must be registered immediately after participating in that Match.
- (iii) A Club that repeatedly fields an unregistered Player may forfeit Match Points and/or incur the applicable sanction under Regulation 1.14 and Appendix 5.7.

5.11. JUNIOR REGRADING

- 5.11.1.** The BHRDCA reserves the right to regrade a Team or Teams if it is deemed to be in the best interests of the Junior Competition and affiliated Clubs.
- 5.11.2.** The BHRDCA is responsible for advising affected Clubs of any regrading and the round after which the determination applies.
- 5.11.3.** The regrading decision will also determine whether match points earned, or batting and bowling averages achieved move with the regraded Teams or not.

5.12. JUNIOR COMPETITIONS - MATCH RULES

5.12.1. Playing Hours

- (i) Junior Competition Matches shall be played in line with the below playing hours:

Grade	Playing Hours
Saturday – 50 Over Grades	8:30am – 11:45am
Sunday Grades	9:00am – 11:45am
Twilight – 50 Over Grades	4:45pm – 8:15pm
Super 7's	Maximum 2 hours
Fast 9's	Maximum 2.5 hours

- (ii) An additional ten (10) minutes per change of innings per day is permitted.
- (iii) On non-daylight savings dates, play commences 30 minutes earlier and concludes 30 minutes earlier.

5.12.2. Overs in a Day

- (i) The maximum overs to be bowled in a day's play unless reduced under other provisions shall be:

Match Type	Maximum Overs
Saturday / Sunday Grades	50 overs (reduced by 2 overs for every 7 minutes lost)
Twilight Grades	50 overs (reduced by 2 overs for every 7 minutes lost)

- (ii) The number of overs to be bowled is not reduced if there is a change of innings:
- Saturday and Sunday Grades – No match shall continue beyond 11:45am
 - Twilight Grades – No match shall continue beyond 8:15pm unless a result is imminent (and there are overs remaining).
- (iii) In Under 14, Under 16 and Under 18 One-Day and Two-Day Matches, the last over, as determined by the Umpire, shall conclude only once six (6) legitimate deliveries have been bowled.

5.12.3. Follow-on

- (i) No Follow-On can be imposed or Outright result achieved in all BHRDCA Junior Competitions.

5.12.4. Compulsory Closure

One-Day Matches

- (i) If play commences on time and there are no interruptions, the first innings must be closed at the completion of the 25th over.
- (ii) If play is delayed or interrupted:
 - a. Saturday Competition: 25 overs less two (2) overs for every seven (7) minutes delay to the start of play or interruption of play. A minimum of 17 overs must be bowled in an innings to constitute a match.
 - b. Twilight Competition: 25 overs less two (2) overs for every seven (7) minutes delay to the start of play or interruption of play. A minimum of 17 overs must be bowled in an innings to constitute a match.
- (iii) The Team batting second's innings is to be compulsory closed once it has received the same number of overs as the Team batting first was entitled to receive before compulsory closure.
- (iv) For the purpose of this Compulsory Closure Regulation, an over that has commenced but is not completed counts as a completed over.
- (v) The Team batting second, does not receive the unbowled overs where the Team batting first is dismissed in less than the scheduled overs allocation.

Two-Day Matches

- (i) Where play commences on time and there are no interruptions, the Team batting first's innings must be closed at the earlier completion of the 50th over, or 11:45am for Saturday/Sunday matches, or 8:00pm for Twilight matches.
- (ii) If Team A batting first is dismissed prior to receiving its full allocation of overs, the unused overs are to be added on to Team B's total allowance.
- (iii) If Team A's innings was compulsory closed, Team B's innings is to be compulsory closed once it has received the same number of overs.
- (iv) Where play on Day One is delayed or interrupted, Team A may continue its innings on Day Two until it has received half of the total overs available across both days.

5.12.5. Batting

- (i) The batter in all BHRDCA Junior Grades must wear a helmet with a grill compliant with the British Safety Specification standards number: BS 7928:2013.
- (ii) Each Team must have at least three (3) helmets available for the duration of each match.
- (iii) More than eleven (11) players may bat, but a Team will be dismissed when it has lost ten (10) wickets.
- (iv) A batter may be non-compulsorily retired by the Team Manager/Coach:
 - a. In the U18 & U16 Grades at any time;
 - b. Retired batter (U18 & U16 Grades only) – if required once all other batters have been dismissed, compulsorily or non-compulsorily retired batters can return to the crease in lowest to highest scoring order.
 - c. There is no non-compulsory retirement in all U14 & U12 Grades.
- (v) Batters are to be compulsorily retired immediately upon reaching the retirement limit for their grade as follows:

Grade	Non-Compulsory	Compulsory
U18	Any Time	Two-Day - 100 Runs / One-Day - 50 Runs
U16	Any Time	Two-Day - 100 Runs / One-Day - 50 Runs
U14	Not Applicable	Two-Day 60 Balls / One-Day 30 Balls (Inclusive of No Balls & Wides)
U12	Not Applicable	Two-Day 30 Balls / One-Day 15 Balls (Inclusive of No Balls & Wides)

- (vi) U12 & U14 Retirement & Return to Bat
 - a. U12 & U14 batters must retire upon reaching the ball-faced limit (inclusive of No Balls & Wides) based on the match format as per regulation 4.12.5 (v).
 - b. A retired batter may return, in the original batting order after all other wickets have fallen.
 - c. Each returning batter may face a further allocation of balls equal to the compulsory retirement limit for that match format, with this process continuing until the innings is completed.
- (vii) If a batter who has been compulsorily or non-compulsorily retired fails to return to bat, the batter will be deemed dismissed unless the failure to return is due to injury, illness or unavoidable absence.
- (viii) If a batter who was temporarily retired hurt is unable to return after the fall of the second last wicket, the batter will be deemed Retired Hurt (not out) and the innings of the batting Team will be closed.
- (ix) If a batter involved in the last wicket partnership is injured:
 - a. A maximum of ten (10) minutes is to be allowed for the batter to recover.
 - b. If the injury occurs within ten (10) minutes of a scheduled break, the break is to be taken immediately.

- c. If the batter is unable to resume within the ten (10) minute time limit or at the end of the break, the batter will be deemed Retired Hurt (not out) and the innings of the batting Team will be closed.

(x) Batting Retirement Summary:

5.12.6. New batter incoming after a dismissal

(i) Where a batter is dismissed Caught, the new batter shall face the next ball, unless the dismissal occurs on the last ball of the over;

(ii) Where a batter is dismissed Run Out, the new batter shall go to the end at which the dismissal occurred;

5.12.7. Mankad Dismissals

- (i) No batter in any BHRDCA Junior Grade may be dismissed by the “Mankad” mode of dismissal.
- (ii) Team Managers and Coaches must remind their batters of their responsibility not to use this rule as an opportunity to gain an unfair advantage or steal runs.
- (iii) For any subsequent breach following a warning, the ball shall be called dead, no run will be recorded and the delivery must be re-bowled.

5.12.8. Bowling

(i) Bowling restrictions apply for all BHRDCA Junior Competitions as follows:

Grade	Match Format	Maximum Overs per Bowler	Over Called	Overs per End
U18	Two-Day	6 Overs in the first 30 overs (maximum 12)	6 Balls (incl wides & no-balls)	5/5 Blocks
U18	One-Day	6 Overs		
U16	Two-Day	6 Overs in the first 30 overs (maximum 10)		
U16	One-Day	6 Overs		
U14	Two-Day	5 Overs in the first 35 Overs (maximum 9)		
U14	One-Day	5 Overs		
U12	Two-Day	5 Overs		
U12	One-Day	3 Overs		

(ii) For U12 Competitions:

- a. The maximum overs per bowler may be increased where a Team has fewer than 11 players.
- b. Every player must bowl 2 overs before any player bowls a 3rd, excluding the wicketkeeper.
- c. An over must consist of 6 balls, regardless of wides and no-balls.
- d. A player may be exempt from bowling if they have been injured during the match, or have a pre-existing medical condition preventing them from bowling.

(iii) Twilight Matches (All Grades):

- a. Bowling shall be conducted in blocks of 5 overs from one end, then switching ends for the next 5-over block.

(iv) Daylight Matches (U12, U14 & U16 Grades):

- a. Bowling shall be conducted in blocks of 5 overs from one end, then switching ends for the next 5-over block.

5.12.9. Wicketkeepers

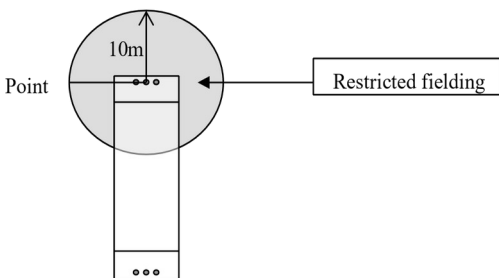
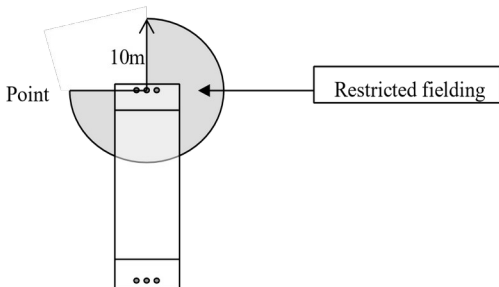
- (i) Wicketkeepers in all BHRDCA Junior Grades must wear a helmet with a grille when keeping up to the stumps.
- (ii) Wicketkeepers in U12 Grades must always wear a helmet with a grille, irrespective of whether they're keeping up to the stumps or not.

5.12.10. Fielding

- (i) Number of Fielders:
 - a. A maximum of 11 fielders, including the bowler may be on the field at any time.
 - b. Where a Team has more than 11 players, players may rotate through the field, provided no more than 11 fielders are on the field at any one time.

(ii) U12 & U14 Fielding Restrictions

Restricted fielding zones apply as follows:

Grade	Restricted Area
U12	No fielder (other than the wicketkeeper) may field within 10 metres of the batter. The restricted area extends 10 metres directly in front of the strikers stumps and returns to the pitch in a 10-metre arc radius.  The diagram shows a top-down view of a cricket pitch. The stumps are represented by three dots. A rectangular area 10 metres long extends directly in front of the stumps. This rectangle is part of a larger circular area with a 10-metre radius, centered on the stumps. The area within the circle but outside the rectangle is shaded grey. An arrow points from the text 'Restricted fielding' to this shaded area. A label 'Point' with an arrow points to the top edge of the rectangle. A '10m' label with an arrow indicates the radius of the circle.
U14	No fielder (other than the wicketkeeper) may field within 10 metres of the batter. The restricted area extends 10 metres directly in front of the striker's stumps and continues in a 10-metre arc radius around and behind the stumps to square leg.  The diagram is similar to the U12 one, showing a pitch with stumps and a 10-metre rectangular area in front. However, the shaded circular area with a 10-metre radius extends around the stumps, including behind them towards square leg. An arrow points from the text 'Restricted fielding' to this shaded area. A label 'Point' with an arrow points to the top edge of the rectangle. A '10m' label with an arrow indicates the radius of the circle.

(iii) Protective Equipment- U16 & U18 Grades:

- a. Any fielder positioned in front of the stumps and within 10 metres of the batter must wear a helmet and protector.
- b. Equipment must comply with Cricket Australia's 2016/17 policy and British Standard BS 7928:2013.

(iv) Umpires Enforcement:

- a. The umpire at the bowler's end must prevent the delivery of a ball if the fielder is inside or enters the restricted zone prior to the ball being bowled.

(v) Leg Side Fielding Limits:

- a. No more than five (5) fielders may be on the leg side.
- b. No more than two (2) players may field behind square leg.
- c. The Umpire may call a dead ball if any of the above two occur.

5.12.11. No Balls

- (i) Umpires shall determine No Balls in accordance with the relevant provisions of the BHRDCA Senior Competition Rules and where applicable, the MCC Laws of Cricket (2017 Code).

(ii) A No Ball must be called when:

- a. High Bouncing Delivery – the ball bounces and passes or would have passed, above the striker's shoulder while standing in their normal batting stance at the popping crease;
- b. High Full Toss – a full-pitched delivery passes or would have passed, above the striker's waist while standing in their normal batting stance at the popping crease (a full-pitched delivery is not a No Ball if the striker has advanced beyond the popping crease before the ball reaches them); or
- c. Multiple Bounce Delivery – the ball bounces or strikes the playing surface more than once before reaching the striker's popping crease.

(iii) Scoring a No Ball:

- a. Byes and Leg Byes taken from a No Ball are recorded as Byes or Leg Byes, not as part of the No Ball tally. Examples below:
 - i. Bowler balls a No Ball;
 - ii. Ball goes to the boundary for four Byes;
 - iii. Scorers record: 1 No Ball + 4 Byes = 5 runs total;
 - iv. Bowler is credited with only the No Ball

5.12.12. Wides

- (i) Umpires shall determine Wides in accordance with the relevant provisions of the BHRDCA Senior Competition Rules and where applicable, the MCC Laws of Cricket (2017 Code).
- (ii) All runs resulting from a Wide including the penalty run are recorded as Wides and are credited against the bowler.

5.13. JUNIOR FINALS

5.13.1. All BHRDCA Junior Competitions will conclude with a Finals Series, played as per below format:

- (i) The Teams finishing in 1st, 2nd, 3rd & 4th position will qualify for finals.
- (ii) Semi Final 1 – Team 1 vs Team 4
- (iii) Semi Final 2 – Team 2 vs Team 3
- (iv) The winners of the Semi Final will playoff in the Grand Final
- (v) If a Semi Final concludes without at least a first innings result being achieved, the Team that finished in the higher position on the ladder at the end of the Home & Away Season will be declared the winner.
- (vi) The winner of the Grand Final will be crowned 2026/27 Season Premiers for their respective Grade.
- (vii) If a Grand Final concludes without at least a first innings result, the premiership will be shared between the two Teams.

5.13.2. Substitute players can be used in finals matches only if:

- (i) The Team Manager / Coach declares the substitution to the appointed Umpire, or where no Umpire is present, to the opposing Team Manager / Coach.
- (ii) The substitute player is registered on PlayHQ and is eligible to play.
- (iii) Substitutes are noted on the Team Sheet and scorecard, if allowed.

5.13.3. Player Eligibility:

- (i) Unless a Permit has been issued by the CoM, a Player must have been physically present and participated in a minimum of three (3) Home & Away Matches for that Team in that Grade during the current season to be eligible for that Team's Finals Series. For Grades in which Players are twelve (12) years of age or under, Finals qualification may be considered on a case-by-case basis.

5.14. FAST 9's & SUPER 7's

5.14.1. Fast 9's

Purpose: Fast 9's is designed for Players in approximately their second or third year of Junior Cricket and is a skills-based participation format. Premiership Match Points do not apply.

Ball: BHRDCA-approved 142g hard leather ball.

Time: Maximum 2.5 hours; Team 1 bats for a maximum 75 minutes and Team 2 bats for a maximum 75 minutes.

Innings: Maximum 25 overs or 75 minutes, or until eight (8) wickets are lost.

Boundary: Maximum 45-metre diameter measured from the centre of the pitch.

Pitch: 18.1 metres, with 17.7 metres crease to crease.

Team size: Nine (9) Players recommended; format can operate with seven (7) to eleven (11) Players.

Protective equipment: A helmet with grille compliant with BS 7928:2013 must be worn as required, including by the Wicketkeeper, together with batting pads, gloves and protector.

Batting: Batters retire after facing 25 balls. Retired batters may return after all other batters have batted, in order of retirement. All balls, including Wides and No Balls, count towards the 25-ball limit. The innings closes when eight (8) wickets are lost.

Bowling: An over is a maximum of six (6) balls including Wides and No Balls. All Players, including the Wicketkeeper, must bowl. No Player may bowl more than four (4) overs. Ends change after 13 overs.

Fielding: No fielder may be within 10 metres of the batter or another fielder except the Wicketkeeper, slips and gully. Fielders should rotate through positions. Two Wicketkeepers are required per innings, keeping for 13 and 12 overs respectively. Where more than nine (9) Players are selected, Players rotate on and off each over and no more than nine (9) fielders may be on the field at one time.

Dismissals: All modes of dismissal apply except Mankad and LBW.

Minimum Players: A Team may commence with seven (7) Players.

5.14.2. Super 7's

Purpose: Super 7's is an introductory Club competition focused on participation, skill development and game sense. Premiership Match Points do not apply.

Coach: An accredited Community Level 1 Coach, or current equivalent recognised accreditation, is required.

Ball: BHRDCA-approved soft ball.

Time: Maximum two (2) hours; Team 1 bats for a maximum 60 minutes and Team 2 bats for a maximum 60 minutes.

Innings: Maximum 20 overs or 60 minutes per Team.

Boundary: Maximum 40-metre diameter measured from the batter's stumps.

Pitch: 16 metres.

Team size: Seven (7) Players recommended; format can operate with five (5) to nine (9) Players.

Protective equipment: Helmet with grille, including for the Wicketkeeper, compliant with BS 7928:2013, together with batting pads, gloves and protector.

Batting: In a seven-Player Team, batters retire after 17 balls. An additional ball may be allowed where required to complete the full innings quota. All balls, including Wides and No Balls, count towards the retirement limit.

Adjusted Super 7's allocations:

Players	Bowling allocation	Batters retire after
5	5 × 4 overs	24 balls
6	2 × 4 overs, 4 × 3 overs	20 balls
7	3 × 4 overs, 2 × 3 overs, 2 × 1 over	17 balls
8	6 × 3 overs, 2 × 1 over	15 balls
9	4 × 3 overs, 3 × 2 overs, 2 × 1 over	13 balls

Bowling: An over is a maximum of six (6) balls including Wides and No Balls. All Players, including the Wicketkeeper, must bowl. No Player may bowl more than four (4) overs. Bowlers operate from one end, with the end changing only at the change of innings.

Fielding: No fielder may be within 15 metres of the batter or another fielder except the Wicketkeeper. Fielders should rotate through positions. Two Wicketkeepers are used for ten (10) overs each. Where more than seven (7) Players are selected, Players rotate on and off each over and no more than seven (7) fielders may be on the field at one time.

Dismissals: Dismissals are unlimited until the Team has faced its full innings quota. All modes of dismissal apply except Mankad and LBW.

6. APPENDIX

6.1. CODE OF BEHAVIOUR

As a condition of participation in BHRDCA competitions, all clubs, players, officials, volunteers, parents, spectators and members must comply with this Code of Behaviour and uphold the Spirit of Cricket.

Role Of Clubs

Clubs shall:

- Promote and enforce this Code of Behaviour.
- Exercise care in the selection of captains, coaches and team officials.
- Support captains and officials in maintaining appropriate standards of conduct.
- Take responsibility for the behaviour of their players, members, supporters and spectators.
- Ensure compliance with Cricket Australia Child Safety, Member Protection and Integrity policies.

Role Of Captains

Captains are responsible for:

- Ensuring play is conducted within the Laws and Spirit of Cricket.
- Supporting umpires and respecting their authority.
- Assisting in the efficient and timely conduct of matches.
- Addressing inappropriate behaviour by players immediately.
- Leading by example at all times.

Attitude Towards Umpires

- Umpires are in charge of the match and their decisions must be respected.
- Players, officials, parents and spectators must not dispute, argue, ridicule or abuse umpires.
- Dissent, aggressive gestures or negative reactions to decisions are unacceptable.
- Concerns regarding umpiring should be raised through the appropriate club or Association process after the match.

Role Of Players

Players shall:

- Treat opponents, teammates, officials and spectators with respect and courtesy.
- Avoid abusive, offensive, threatening or discriminatory language or behaviour.
- Refrain from sledging, taunting, intimidation or personal criticism.
- Accept both success and disappointment with good sportsmanship.
- Not throw equipment, display excessive anger or engage in retaliatory behaviour.
- Assist captains and umpires in the smooth running of matches.
- Cross on the field when changing batters.
- Be ready to bowl, field and change positions without unnecessary delay.
- Avoid actions that waste time or bring the game into disrepute.
- Not consume alcohol or illegal substances while participating in matches.

Coaches, Team Managers & Officials

Coaches, managers and officials shall:

- Model respectful and positive behaviour.
- Promote player development, wellbeing and enjoyment.
- Prioritise child safety at all times.
- Address inappropriate behaviour by players, parents or spectators promptly.

Parents & Spectators

Parents and spectators shall:

- Encourage and support all participants positively.
- Respect supporters, umpires, players, coaches and officials.
- Not coach from the boundary during junior matches unless authorised.
- Not engage in abuse, harassment, intimidation or disruptive behaviour.
- Comply with any reasonable direction from club or Association officials.

Social Media & Digital Conduct

Participants must:

- Adhere to the BHRDCA social Media Policy.
- Use social media responsibly and respectfully.
- Not post content that is abusive, offensive, discriminatory, defamatory or harmful.
- Not target players, officials, clubs, umpires or volunteers online.
- Recognise that online behaviour is subject to the same standards as behaviour at a venue.

General Expectation

All participants must act in a manner that reflects positively on cricket, their club and the BHRDCA. Any conduct that is contrary to the Spirit of Cricket, brings the game into disrepute, or breaches Association policies may result in disciplinary action under BHRDCA Rules, Regulations and Tribunal Procedures.

6.2. INJURY CODE

1. Where a player suffers an injury during the course of a match which causes bleeding, then the Umpires, (or Captains or junior Team Managers where no umpire is present), shall decide that player must immediately retire from the match until such time as First Aid has been administered to prevent further bleeding. The player cannot resume playing unless the bleeding has stopped, or the wound is securely covered.
2. A batter who is injured and has temporarily retired under clause 1, and who is unable to return after the fall of the ninth wicket, shall be deemed Retired Hurt (Not Out) and the innings of the batting team deemed closed.
3. Where an injury occurs to a batter involved in the tenth wicket partnership, a maximum of ten minutes shall be allowed in order to comply with clause 1. Where this injury occurs within ten minutes of the scheduled tea adjournment, tea shall be taken immediately with no extra time being added. If that batter is unable to resume within the ten minute time limit or at the end of the tea break, then the batter shall be deemed to be Retired Hurt (Not out) and the innings of the batting team deemed closed.
4. There shall be no reduction to the number of overs to be bowled when time is lost due to an injury.
5. All home teams shall provide a First Aid Kit to be available to both competing teams. The kit shall contain as a minimum: Bandages, Cotton Wool, Gauze, Adhesive Plaster, Band-Aids, Closures, Scissors, Tweezers, Antiseptic, Disposable Gloves, Disposable Plastic Bags, Ice Pack.

6.3. TRIBUNAL PROCEDURES

Purpose

These procedures govern the hearing and determination of misconduct and Code of Behaviour matters referred to the BHRDCA Tribunal.

Background

A player, coach, team official, spectator or Club may be reported by an Umpire, Club or BHRDCA Official for alleged misconduct or a breach of an applicable Code, Rule or Policy. Reports may be submitted using the prescribed BHRDCA reporting process.

Reports shall be handled in the following manner:

- The BHRDCA Competition Administrator shall perform all administrative duties relating to communications between clubs and the Tribunal Chairperson and Competition Management Platform adjustments relating to received reports.
- This will include verbal and written confirmation from the alleged offending player and/or Club that the communication has been received.
- The Tribunal Chairperson shall coordinate the panel from a pool of volunteers.
- For offences that fall within the guidelines of the Set Penalty Table (SPT) a prescribed penalty shall be offered
- If the accused challenges the charge, or it is of a serious nature, (level 5) the matter shall be referred to the Tribunal for a hearing.

NOTE: Refer to **"BHRDCA Procedure for Reports"** for full details

Tribunal Panel

- The panel shall be made up of 3 volunteers
- The Tribunal Chairperson shall maintain a pool of volunteers to source from (suggest 6+)
- Pool should be made up of Chairperson, backup Chairperson (Panel member), regular Panel members (min 3) + Admin members (min 2)
- Wherever possible there should be no conflict of interest relating to own club hearings
- One of the panel takes the role of Administration for the hearing. This person shall be responsible for the recording of the hearing and completing the Tribunal Administration sheet.

Pre-Hearing Requirements

- BHRDCA Competition Administrator completes all admin relating to scheduling of hearings and advice of hearings to impacted parties.
- BHRDCA Competition Administrator provides a copy of Tribunal Hearing Procedures to all attending parties.
- BHRDCA Competition Administrator contacts Tribunal Chairperson to advise of required hearing.
- BHRDCA Competition Administrator shall also provide details of any previous convictions of the reported player to the Tribunal Chairperson/Secretary.

Tribunal Hearing Scheduling Requirements

- Wherever possible, tribunal hearings must be held on a Wednesday evening to ensure that any penalties applied do not interfere with common player selection practices at clubs.
- Wednesday Night hearings fit in line with current guidelines and notification period.
- Tribunal Hearings should start at 7.30pm.
- If multiple cases required, suggest hourly intervals to be coordinated by BHRDCA Competition Administrator
- Location is at the discretion of and to be organised by the Tribunal Chairperson (liaise with BHRDCA Competition Administrator for advice purposes).
- The panel shall be assembled by the Tribunal Chairperson based on availability and to avoid any conflict of interest.

Administration

- The Tribunal Chairperson shall ensure that all attendees and advocates at the hearing are made aware of and accept the guidelines for the hearing (printed copy of Tribunal Hearing Procedures to be provided to all to be read and acknowledged).
- At the sole discretion of the Tribunal Chairperson, a smartphone or physical recording device **may be used** to record proceedings.
- If the Tribunal Chairperson elects to record the proceedings all attendees must be notified prior to the commencement of the hearing.
- The recorded proceedings can be used for Administrative purposes at the discretion of the Tribunal.
- A Prescribed tribunal admin form must be completed by the Tribunal Admin.
- The form is sent to the BHRDCA Competition Administrator for action and to be kept for reference in the event of an appeal or other necessary use.

Tribunal Hearing Procedure

Attendees:

- Tribunal Panel (Chairperson + 2 members)
- Reporting Umpire(s)
- Umpire's Advocate
- Person charged with the offence
- Player's Advocate
- Witnesses

Hearing Procedure:

The Tribunal Chairperson shall read out the Hearing Procedures steps document and provide the person charged/player and Player's Advocate (if in attendance) with a printed copy of the Hearing Procedures steps that are detailed below:

- (i) All attendees shall be required to acknowledge and accept the procedures before the hearing commences.
- (ii) All witnesses excluding the reported player and the Umpire(s) must leave the hearing room.
- (iii) The Tribunal Chairperson shall read the written report from the Umpire(s) and ask the player for their plea.
- (iv) The person charged/player or Player's Advocate shall enter their plea. If the plea is 'Not Guilty' the person charged/player shall be allowed to make a statement after the evidence from the Umpire(s) is completed (**Refer viii**).
- (v) The Umpire(s) or Umpire's Advocate shall give their version of the events.
- (vi) The person charged, Player's Advocate or player if no advocate is present may question the Umpire(s) but only on the facts stated or those detailed in the written report.
- (vii) If new issues (not new evidence) are raised by the advocate's questions, the Umpire's Advocate may explore these issues.

- (viii) The person charged/player then gives their statement. No character reference etc., is allowed during the giving of evidence (Character references shall be allowed after the Tribunal hands down its verdict).
- (ix) The Umpire's Advocate can question the player but only on the facts stated.
- (x) Any other witnesses are then called in turn to make their statements and the same procedure as above shall apply.
- (xi) Once all evidence has been heard the Tribunal shall make its decision.
- (xii) The Umpire(s) shall leave the hearing at this stage and shall not be required again.
- (xiii) If the verdict is 'Guilty' and before the determining of any penalty, the person charged, Player's Advocate or the player if no advocate is present may give a report or character reference about the player.
- (xiv) The Chairperson of the Tribunal shall advise of any recorded prior convictions.
- (xv) The Chairperson of the Tribunal shall then advise of any penalty.
- (xvi) The Chairperson of the Tribunal shall then explain the Appeals process.

Verdict

- The appeals process must be explained at the conclusion of any Hearing and that any timing associated with an appeal to the VMCU would only take place after their period of determination would occur.
- Tribunal Chairperson to deliver verdict, including reasons.
- Discussion surrounding the reasons/fairness of the verdict shall only be entered into at the discretion of the Tribunal Chairperson.

Post Hearing Admin

- Tribunal Secretary sends copy of Tribunal Admin form to the BHRDCA Competition Administrator for filing and further reference.
- BHRDCA Competition Administrator advises impacted clubs of outcome of hearing (cc: BHRDCA CoM Executive).
- BHRDCA Competition Administrator updates the Competition Management Platform as necessary.
- BHRDCA Competition Administrator updates season suspension spreadsheet for publishing on the BHRDCA Website.

6.4. BHRDCA APPEAL PROCEDURES

These procedures apply to appeals arising from decisions made under the BHRDCA Competition Rules and are subject to the applicable BHRDCA By-Laws and Corporate Rules.

6.4.1. Appeals from Tribunal Decisions to the Committee of Management

- (i) A decision of the BHRDCA Tribunal may be appealed to the Committee of Management (CoM) in accordance with these procedures.
- (ii) An Affiliate seeking to appeal a Tribunal decision accepts that:
 - a. only one appeal may be made in relation to the relevant decision;
 - b. the appeal must be lodged in writing within five (5) clear days of the decision or hearing date which is the subject of the appeal; and
 - c. the prescribed appeal fee must accompany the appeal.
- (iii) The appeal fee may be forfeited where the Appeal Board determines that the appeal is frivolous.
- (iv) An appeal shall not proceed unless:
 - a. the Affiliate has received written notice from the Association of the decision being appealed; and
 - b. the appeal must be the Affiliate is fully financial with the Association and has no overdue financial debt.

6.4.2. Appeal Board and Appeal Panel

- (i) In determining an appeal, the CoM may:
 - a. act as the Appeal Board; or
 - b. appoint an Appeal Panel to hear the appeal and report to the CoM.
- (ii) Where an Appeal Panel is appointed, it shall provide a report to the CoM, including any recommendations it considers appropriate.
- (iii) The CoM shall determine the appeal after considering the Appeal Panel's report and recommendations.
- (iv) Any person who is either of the below (see a and b) must not serve on the Appeal Board or Appeal Panel for that appeal.
 - a. was involved in the original hearing; or
 - b. has an actual or perceived conflict of interest
- (v) The Appeal Board may appoint a replacement for any person excluded under Regulation 5.4.2(iv).

6.4.3. Determination of an Appeal

- (i) An appeal decision takes effect immediately upon being announced by the Appeal Board.
- (ii) Following an appeal, the original Tribunal decision may be:
 - a. confirmed;
 - b. revoked; or
 - c. varied.
- (iii) Where a suspension of not more than two (2) full seasons is confirmed or varied, the suspension shall be expressed in terms of:
 - a. the number of rounds and/or weeks applicable to the competition and Grade in which the offence occurred; and
 - b. a specific period of time, including the End Date of the suspension.
- (iv) Where the number of rounds or weeks and the specified End Date would result in different periods of suspension, the period resulting in the later End Date shall apply.
- (v) When determining an End Date, consideration should be given to the different playing days used across BHRDCA Competitions. Where appropriate, the End Date should be specified as a Monday so that all matches scheduled during the relevant weekend are captured by the suspension.
- (vi) A suspension applies to active participation of any kind in all BHRDCA Competitions and age groups for the duration of the suspension.

6.4.4. Conduct of Appeals Hearings

- (i) Subject to relevance and these Competition Rules, an appeal hearing shall follow the applicable procedures for BHRDCA Tribunal hearings contained in Appendix 5.3 – Tribunal Procedures, together with any applicable BHRDCA or VMCU By-Laws.

6.4.5. Appeals from Committee of Management Decisions to the Tribunal

- (i) A decision of the CoM that is eligible for appeal under the applicable BHRDCA By-Laws may be appealed to the BHRDCA Tribunal sitting as an Appeal Board
- (ii) Where applicable, the procedures contained in Regulations 5.4.2 to 5.4.5 shall also apply to an appeal made under this Regulation.

6.4.6. Grounds for Appealing a Tribunal Decision

- (i) An appeal against a Tribunal decision may only be made where the appellant, being a player or Club, claims that one or more of the following grounds apply:
 - a. based on the evidence presented at the Tribunal hearing, the decision reached by the Tribunal Panel was incorrect;
 - b. based on the evidence presented at the Tribunal hearing, the penalty imposed by the Tribunal Panel was manifestly excessive; or
 - c. the Tribunal Panel did not follow the hearing procedures contained in Appendix 5.3 – Tribunal Procedures, and that failure affected the Tribunal Panel's decision.

6.4.7. Appeals Against Mandated Penalties

- (i) Where a mandated penalty imposed under these Competition Rules is subject to appeal, the appeal must comply with the applicable requirements of this Appendix.
- (ii) The five (5) clear day requirement in Regulation 5.4.2(ii)(b) does not apply to an appeal against a scheduled fine imposed under Appendix 5.7 – Schedule of Administration Fees.
- (iii) The BHRDCA CoM shall determine whether an appeal against a mandated penalty meets the requirements to be heard in accordance with the applicable Regulations.

6.5. YELLOW & RED DISCIPLINARY CARD

Disciplinary cards are used in many sports as a means of warning, reprimanding, or penalising a player, coach, or Team Official. The cards are most often used by umpires to indicate that a player has committed an offence. The Official shall hold the card above their head while looking or pointing towards the player that has committed the offence. This action makes the decision clear to all players, as well as spectators and other Officials in a manner that is language-neutral. The colour or shape of the card used by the Official indicates the type or seriousness of the offence and the level of punishment that is to be applied. **Yellow and Red disciplinary cards** are the most common, typically indicating, respectively, cautions and/or **dismissals** from a playing arena.

In all Grades & matches (Senior or Junior) where a BHRDCA Umpires Association Official(s) is/are appointed, any such Official(s) shall be the arbiter of:

- a. Actions that constitute unsportsmanlike behaviour
- b. Actions that bring the game into disrepute

YELLOW CARD

1. If, in the opinion of the appointed Official(s), a team member transgresses in a manner where their actions can be considered to be that described under (a) and/or (b) above, the Official(s) may indicate a **Yellow disciplinary card** has been earned by that team member. The Official(s) shall warn the offender that their actions contravene the Spirit of the game and have resulted in a **Yellow card** penalty.
2. If, in the opinion of the appointed Official(s), the same team member transgresses again in a manner where their actions can be considered to be that described under (a) and/or (b) above, the Official(s) may indicate a **second Yellow disciplinary card** has been earned by that team member. The Official(s) shall warn the offender that their actions contravene the Spirit of the game and have resulted in a second **Yellow card** penalty.
3. If, in the opinion of the appointed Official(s), the same team member transgresses again in a manner where their actions can be considered to be that described under (a) and/or (b) above, the Official(s) may indicate a **Red disciplinary card** has been earned by that team member and they shall be automatically referred to the Tribunal, with the Team's Captain also automatically receiving a first **Yellow card** issue.

RED CARD

1. If, in the opinion of the appointed Official(s), a team member excessively transgresses in a manner where their actions can be considered to be that described under (a) and/or (b) above, the Official(s) may indicate a Red disciplinary card has been earned by that team member. The Official(s) shall warn the offending individual that their actions contravene the Spirit of the game and have resulted in a Red card penalty.
2. That team member shall be **reported and** immediately referred to the BHRDCA Tribunal, with the Team's Captain also automatically receiving a **Yellow card** issue.

OTHER

If an individual Team member, during the season, receives **three separate Yellow cards in the same season**, they shall automatically be suspended for the duration of the next fixtured BHRDCA match (any Two or One Day match) and cannot participate in any other BHRDCA Competition matches (e.g., T20 match, BHRDCA Representative match etc. that may be scheduled during that suspension period) **until the suspension is fully served.**

Should a T20 Guest player (i.e. a player not registered with a Club for BHRDCA Saturday cricket), incur three separate Yellow cards in the same season, they shall automatically be suspended for the **next fixtured T20 match.** Any further **Yellow card** incurred by the same individual Team member shall result in a further automatic one match suspension .

If a single team receive **five separate Yellow cards** throughout the season the Team's Captain shall automatically be suspended for the duration of the next fixtured BHRDCA match (any Two, One Day or T20 game) and cannot participate in any other BHRDCA Competition matches (e.g., T20 match, BHRDCA Representative match etc.) until the suspension is fully served.

Guest players participating in BHRDCA competition matches e.g. T20 matches, are also subject to this disciplinary process.

Where an Umpire has issued a **Yellow or Red card** and circumstances occur outside the disciplinary process outlined above, the offender and/or their Captain and Team, shall be dealt with by the BHRDCA Committee of Management or if required, BHRDCA Tribunal.

All Yellow disciplinary cards incurred throughout the **Home & Away Season** are reset at the conclusion of the current season and do not carry over to the following season, while any suspension applied by the BHRDCA Tribunal subsequent to a **Red disciplinary card** being issued, must be fully served until the player is eligible to return to play on the Round and/or Date specified by the BHRDCA Tribunal.

All Yellow Disciplinary cards incurred throughout the Final Series, carry over to the following season, where a Tribunal has not already sat and/or determined a suspension outcome for the disciplined member.

The BHRDCA appointed Official shall advise on their Umpires Report the impost of any **Yellow/Red** cards within **48 hours of the conclusion of the match.**

6.6. PLAYER POINTS SYSTEM

The Player Points System (PPS) is designed to promote competitive balance in the BHRDCA's Senior Men's Shield Grades, by assigning point values to players based on their playing history and experience.

A team subject to the PPS may select any combination of eligible players, provided its total Player Points do not exceed the permitted Team Points limit.

The PPS applies only to those Clubs fielding a First XI Team in the below Senior Men's Shield Grades:

- Ray McIntosh Shield (RMS)
- Howard Wilson Shield (HWS)
- Dorothy McIntosh Shield (DMS)
- Peter White Shield (PWS)

The PPS does not apply where a club's First XI competes in A Grade and below, or in a One Day Competition.

A Team subject to the PPS rules cannot exceed the total of Twenty (20) Points per match.

Player Types

A player's initial classification is determined by the highest relevant level of cricket played during the previous four seasons and defined according to the following table:

BHRDCA Player Point Table			
Points / Player Type	Code	Player Type / Category	Description
1	HG	Home Grown	a Player who entered the Club through its Junior program and satisfies the Home Grown qualification requirement, including the applicable 2 qualified-seasons criterion under the PPS.
	BP	Base Player	Player that has received a 'Season Loyalty' reduction to 1 point but has not yet achieved 'Home Grown' status
2	OA	Other Affiliate	Played in VMCU/VCCL affiliated competition or other State equivalent including Victorian Women's Premier Cricket 1 st XI
	OS	Overseas	Overseas 'non-rated' player (not recorded or present on the ICC's ESPN Cricinfo website)
	PR2	Premier 2	Played Premier Cricket or other State equivalent 3 rd or 4 th XI
	VSD2	VSDCA 2	Played VSDCA / other State equivalent 2 nd , 3 rd or 4 th XI
	INA2	Inactive 2	Not played cricket in the past four seasons – Premier Cricket or below (Player Type 3 or below)
3	PR1	Premier 1	Player Premier Cricket or other State equivalent 1 st or 2 nd XI
	VSD1	VSDCA 1	Played VSDCA or other State equivalent 1 st XI
	INA1	Inactive 1	Not played cricket in the past four seasons – Overseas or International (Player Type 4 or 5)
	BHR	BHRDCA Transfer	Player transferring from one BHRDCA Club to another who has fewer than two qualified seasons at their current Club
4	OS	Overseas – Rated	Any overseas 'rated' player below Test level, including List A or equivalent higher honours (verified using the ICC's ESPN Cricinfo website)
5	INT	International	Test level player (verified using the ICC's ESPN Cricinfo website)

Player Point Approval

Player List Submission

Prior to the commencement of each season, Clubs entering Teams in the RMS, HWS, DMS or PWS Grades must submit a Player Point List to the BHRDCA, listing all players they intend to play in those grades during the season.

The submission must include the below information for each player:

- Player Name;
- Cricket ID
- Season Commenced at the Club;
- Relevant previous playing history;
- Number of matches played;
- Proposed Player Type

Each Clubs Player Point List must be submitted to at least 14 days prior to Round 1, or by another date determined by the Committee of Management (CoM).

Assessment & Approval

The BHRDCA and CoM shall assess and confirm each Club's submission in line with the below:

- Assess each player's classification;
- Allocate the applicable Player Points;
- Approve the Club's Player Points List; and
- Publish the approved points allocation through PlayHQ.

Clubs wishing to add additional players to their Player Point List during the season must have those submissions be approved by the BHRDCA. These requests must be submitted to the BHRDCA Competition Administrator by 8:00pm on Thursday prior to the player's first match.

All players must be approved on the official Player Point List prior to taking part in a match. Clubs who fail to have a player approved on the official Player Point List prior to a match commencing shall be fined \$100 as per Regulation 1.14 and the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.

Clubs who fail to have a player approved on the official Player Point List prior to the second match played by that player, shall forfeit all Match Points earned for that Round and may incur the applicable sanction under Regulation 1.14 and Appendix 5.7.

Players competing in the BHRDCA for the first time shall be assessed on their highest level of participation within the past four seasons.

Loyalty Discounts

All players other than Home Grown and Base Players shall have their point allocation reduced by one (1) point following the completion of two (2) qualified-seasons at the same club.

A Player must reach two (2) qualified-seasons at their new Club before the Loyalty Point Deduction applies.

According to Player Type, they shall then reduce their allocation by one (1) point per season until they reach one (1) point status 'Base Player'. See table below

BHRDCA PLAYER LOYALTY POINT REDUCTION TABLE						
Player Type	Season 1	Season 2	Season 3	Season 4	Season 5	Season 6
1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2	2	2	1	1	1	1
3	3	3	2	1	1	1
4	4	4	3	2	1	1
5	5	5	4	3	2	1

For a player to qualify for a 'Loyalty Discount' point reduction, they must be eligible to play in finals in accordance Regulation 3.13.3.(i) If a player plays less than the required number of games to qualify for finals, they shall not be credited with a 'Qualified Season' at their club.

Once a Player attains 'Home Grown' status at a Club, that status is retained for life at that Club, regardless of any movement to and from the BHRDCA.

Club Reviews & Special Consideration

A Club may submit in writing a request or review for 'Player Type' or 'Team Points' consideration to the CoM under extenuating circumstances. Any such application shall be assessed, and the ruling published on the BHRDCA website defining details of any change and the validity of any such change. The onus is on the Club to provide scorebook and registration evidence to support their submissions in the absence of PlayHQ or other Competition Management Platform records. Without such evidence, the submission shall not be approved.

Amendments to the Player Points System

Any proposed amendment to the PPS for the following season must be lodged to the BHRDCA by February 28th of the current season.

This includes proposed amendments to; Player Types, Points Allocations, Loyalty Discounts, Team Points, Qualification Requirements or other PPS provisions.

BHRDCA Player Points Submission Form

The Season 2026/27 BHRDCA Player Points Submission Form can be requested from the BHRDCA Competition Administrator.

Clubs are to complete only sections 1-9; with the BHRDCA to complete the assessment and allocate Player Points.

Form for Clubs to complete; ongoing records shall be held with the BHRDCA CoM. After a player is assessed by the BHRDCA CoM as 'Home Grown' the Player Name and Cricket ID shall be the only fields required for subsequent seasons.

6.7. SCHEDULE OF ADMINISTRATION FEES

Rule Breach	Penalty
Failing to assist in the readiness for play – 3.5.1.(ii)	\$100
Causing Late Start – 3.5.3	\$50
Late Start causing loss of match and forfeit – 3.5.4	\$100 & loss of match points gained
Slow Over Rate – 3.10.8.(ii)	\$100
Grounds and Equipment (each breach) – 1.6.9	\$50
Alcohol & Smoking / Vaping breach – 1.18	\$200
Incorrect Playing Attire – 1.16	\$50
No Scores input via PlayHQ – 3.7.2 & 4.8.3	\$50
Incomplete / Missing / Late PlayHQ Match Report – 3.7.3	\$50
Incomplete / Missing / Late PlayHQ Match Report - more than 7 days late from match completion – 3.7.3	\$100
Incomplete / Missing / Late Captains Report on Umpires - up to 7 days late from match completion – 3.7.4	\$50
Incomplete / Missing / Late Captains Report on Umpires - more than 7 days late from match completion – 3.7.4	\$100
Incomplete / Missing / Late Captains Report on Umpires – Finals – 3.7.4	\$100
Incorrect Umpires Attire – 1.7.8 (iv)	\$50
Forfeit (for each offence) – 3.4.2 & 4.6.2	\$100 minimum & loss of match points gained
Playing an Ineligible or Unregistered Player [Refer Attachment 7 - Player Permits] - for each offence	\$100 minimum & loss of match points gained
Player not included on PPS list - first offence	\$50
Player not included on PPS list - subsequent offence in the same season [Rule 10(b) (iii)]	\$100 & loss of match points
Non Attendance at Prescribed Association Meetings	\$100

Note: The Committee of Management may exercise discretion to impose a sanction of up to \$200 for a forfeit in the final Home & Away round.

- There shall be a sliding scale for offences/breaches listed under this Rule.

- o Up to three (3) administrative breaches incurred per Club per season, the Fee is waived, while more than three (3) administrative breaches; the prescribed penalties apply.
 - o The CoM may at its discretion impose a further penalty up to the maximum allowed under Section 54(d) of the act for repeated breaches of the same Rule during a season or where a fine is specified as a minimum.
- The CoM may at its discretion impose penalties for any breach of competition rules not specified in Regulation 1.14 of the BHRDCA Schedule of Administration Fees.
- These fines may also be imposed where applicable, to breaches of the BHRDCA JUNIOR, VETERANS & T20 RULES.

6.8. EXTREME CONDITIONS POLICY

Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this policy is to protect the health and welfare of participants in BHRDCA Matches from the potential effects of extreme weather, while ensuring that play is not unnecessarily interrupted.

This policy applies to all Matches played in BHRDCA competitions.

Management of Adverse Weather

Where adverse weather, including wet weather or extreme heat, is forecast for a scheduled Match:

In Advance

- (i) BHRDCA shall monitor Bureau of Meteorology forecasts and may amend scheduled playing times where appropriate to maximise the opportunity for play.
- (ii) During periods of extreme heat, BHRDCA may reschedule the commencement of a Match to 10:00am where this is considered appropriate.
- (iii) BHRDCA may consider the full or partial cancellation of fixtured Matches and, where appropriate, seek guidance from the Bureau of Meteorology and/or suitably qualified practitioners.
- (iv) BHRDCA shall provide affected Clubs with reasonable notice of changes to playing times or cancellations through the Club Administration contacts, BHRDCA website and BHRDCA social media channels.

Match Day Morning

- (i) BHRDCA shall consider available ground reports and forecast information before determining whether Matches are to proceed.
- (ii) Any decision shall be communicated to Clubs through the appropriate BHRDCA communication channels.

Match Day

- (i) Where the BHRDCA decision is to report to grounds, decisions regarding the fitness of conditions for play shall be determined by the Umpires in accordance with these Rules and this Policy.

Extreme Heat

SMA Heat Stress Risk

The Sports Medicine Australia (SMA) Extreme Heat Policy Tool shall be used as the Heat Stress Risk measurement for the following competitions:

- Ray McIntosh Shield;
- Howard Wilson Shield;
- Dorothy McIntosh Shield;
- Peter White Shield;
- Senior T20; and
- Under 18.

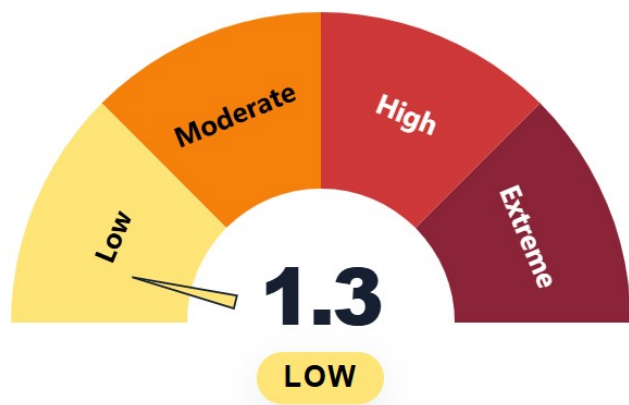
The SMA Tool provides a Heat Stress Risk assessment for cricket using current weather observations for the location of the Match.

The SMA Heat Stress Risk levels are:

- Low – Yellow;
- Moderate – Orange;
- High – Red; and
- Extreme – Dark Red.

Sports Medicine Australia Extreme Heat Policy Tool can be found at the following website:

<https://sma-heat-policy.sydney.edu.au/>



Other Grades – Extreme Heat Activation

For competitions not listed in Regulation 5.8.3(i), the following forecast temperature thresholds shall apply:

Senior Non-Shield Grades – activated where the Melbourne forecast reaches 37°C between 1:00pm and 6:00pm.

Junior Grades – activated where the Melbourne forecast reaches 37°C during:

- Morning Matches – 8:30am to 11:45am; or
- Twilight Matches – 5:00pm to 8:15pm.

Veterans Grades – activated where the Melbourne forecast reaches 37°C between 1:00pm and 6:00pm.

Decisions shall be made at the following times:

- Junior Morning Matches – 7:00am;
- Senior and Veterans Afternoon Matches – 10:00am; and
- Junior Twilight Matches – 2:00pm.

Decisions shall be communicated through the BHRDCA website, social media channels and other appropriate Club communication channels.

Heat Management During Play

Drinks and Intervals

Umpires, Captains and, in Junior Matches, Coaches or Team Officials may allow additional drinks breaks where conditions require.

Any Player may request an additional drinks break where required for their health or welfare.

Bowlers may have drinks available around the boundary.

Where the predicted Heat Stress Risk is Moderate, Umpires and Captains shall conduct a heat-safety briefing before play and determine whether additional drinks breaks are required.

Where the predicted Heat Stress Risk is High or Extreme, Umpires and Captains shall conduct a heat-safety briefing before play to determine:

- the number and duration of drinks intervals;
- unrestricted access to drinks for bowlers around the boundary and at the fall of a wicket;
- whether Players and Umpires may leave the field during drinks breaks; and
- whether an innings break and/or afternoon tea interval should be extended.

Where the observed temperature exceeds 34°C, a minimum of two drinks breaks per session is recommended.

An afternoon tea or innings interval may be extended due to heat by agreement between the Umpires, Captains and, where applicable, Team Officials.

Playing time lost as a result of an extended interval may be made up after the scheduled finishing time where permitted by the applicable Playing Conditions.

Player Rotation and Welfare

A Player affected by the heat may leave the field after notifying the Captain and Umpire.

Where a Team has more than eleven Players available under the applicable Playing Conditions, fielders may be rotated to assist in managing heat.

Umpires, Captains, Coaches and Team Officials shall give particular consideration to Junior Players who have participated in cricket earlier on the same day.

Any Player displaying signs of heat stress shall be removed from the field immediately.

Penalty Time for bowlers and batters shall be reduced by **50%** where a Player leaves the field to avoid or manage a heat-related illness or injury.

No person is required by BHRDCA to participate in a Match where they consider participation may place their health at risk. Clubs must not place pressure on any participant who seeks to withdraw from any part of a Match for health reasons.

Shade, Sun Protection and First Aid

Clubs must provide suitable shaded areas where practicable for batting Teams, scorers and spectators.

Players are encouraged to use appropriate sun protection, including sunscreen, long-sleeved clothing and wide-brimmed hats where appropriate.

First Aid kits must contain appropriate supplies for the treatment and management of heat-related illness.

Clubs should endeavour to have a person available who is trained in recognising and treating heat-related illness.

Clear instructions relating to the treatment of heat-related illness should be readily available near the First Aid kit.

Suspension, Resumption and Abandonment – Extreme Heat

For Matches using the SMA Heat Stress Risk model:

The Home Club Manager, or their nominee, shall monitor the **SMA Extreme Heat Policy Tool** at least every thirty (30) minutes during periods of elevated heat risk.

The suburb in which the Match is being played shall be used when checking the current Heat Stress Risk.

Suspension of Play

Where the Heat Stress Risk reaches **Extreme**, the Umpires shall immediately suspend play.

Resumption of Play

Following a suspension for Extreme Heat Stress Risk, play shall not resume for a minimum of **thirty (30) minutes**.

After the minimum thirty (30) minute suspension, play may recommence where the Heat Stress Risk has reduced to **High or lower**.

Abandonment of Play

The Umpires, in consultation with the Captains, may abandon the day's play following a suspension where the SMA forecast does not indicate that the Heat Stress Risk will fall from **Extreme to High or lower** by the scheduled close of play.

There is no requirement to wait until the scheduled close of play before abandoning the day's play where the forecast indicates that conditions will not improve sufficiently.

Once the day's play has been abandoned because of Extreme Heat Stress Risk, there shall be no resumption of play that day.

Umpire Discretion and Duty of Care

Notwithstanding any temperature or Heat Stress Risk measurement, the Umpires remain responsible for determining whether conditions are safe for play.

Umpires may suspend or abandon play where they consider prolonged or excessive heat creates a danger to the health and welfare of any participant.

In making this assessment, Umpires may consider:

- signs of heat stress displayed by participants;
- the conditions at the individual venue; and
- an air-temperature thermometer properly installed in the shade at the venue.

Conditions at each venue shall be assessed on a case-by-case basis.

Where possible, unrestricted interchange of substitute fielders should be permitted during periods of extreme heat.

Time delays associated with heat-management measures shall be recorded as appropriate allowances when calculating over rates.

Umpires shall seek to facilitate play wherever reasonably possible without compromising their duty of care to participants.

Early Finish – Senior and Veterans Matches

Where extreme conditions exist and a first-innings result has been achieved, both Captains may agree to conclude play early in a Senior or Veterans Match.

Lightning

The **Cricket Victoria Lightning Policy** shall apply to all BHRDCA competitions.

In the event of a thunderstorm, the **30/30 Rule** shall be used to assist in determining when play should be suspended and when it is safe to resume.

When lightning is sighted, the time between the flash of lightning and the sound of thunder should be measured. As sound travels approximately one kilometre every three seconds, a period of less than thirty (30) seconds indicates that the storm is within approximately ten kilometres and is considered dangerous.

Where thunder follows a lightning flash by between **30 and 40 seconds**, play must cease immediately. Players and Umpires must leave the field, although necessary preparations to protect the wicket may be undertaken.

Where thunder follows a lightning flash within **30 seconds**, play must be suspended and Players and Umpires must leave the field immediately.

Players and Umpires must not return to the field for a minimum of **thirty (30) minutes** following a suspension.

Umpires shall monitor lightning and thunder conditions during the suspension.

Play may resume only after a period of at least thirty (30) minutes has passed without thunder or lightning, or where the interval between lightning and thunder has increased to more than forty (40) seconds and the Umpires determine conditions are safe.

Umpires shall reinspect conditions as often as appropriate and advise both Captains of the agreed resumption time.

6.9. PLAYING ATTIRE POLICY

Standard Attire

Players must wear predominantly white or cream cricket attire, including shirts, pullovers and trousers.

Junior players may wear white shorts or alternative attire approved by the Committee of Management (CoM).

Player first names, surnames and numbers are permitted. Nicknames are not permitted.

Coloured Attire

Coloured attire may be worn in T20, One Day, Junior or other approved competitions, subject to prior CoM approval.

Clubs must submit the front and rear design for approval before the attire is worn.

All team members must wear the same or substantially similar style of attire. Teams must not mix coloured attire and traditional whites.

Junior Players: A Junior player participating in a Senior match must comply with the attire requirements applicable to that Senior competition.

Logos and Advertising

Club, sponsor and promotional branding must be appropriate for community sport and must not reasonably distract a batter when worn by a bowler.

Advertising on playing shirts is subject to the following limits:

Requirement	Maximum / Condition
Advertising displays	5 per shirt
Sleeve	1 per sleeve
Breast pocket position	1
Sleeve/breast display	65cm ²
Sleeve display height	10cm
Sleeve/breast display width	10cm
Rear shoulder panel	10cm high x 30cm wide
Manufacturer's logo	Excluded from advertising allowance

Any advertising outside these specifications requires prior CoM approval.

Footwear

Players must not wear footwear containing metal spikes or similar protrusions.

Headwear

Shield Grades

Players wearing headwear other than a protective helmet must wear:

- a recognised Club cap;
- a BHRDCA Representative cap; or
- an approved white or Club-coloured hat.

Other Senior Grades

Players wearing headwear other than a protective helmet may wear:

- a recognised or superseded Club cap;
- a BHRDCA cap;
- an approved white hat; or
- a Club baseball-style cap.

Extreme Conditions

Players are encouraged to wear appropriate protective headwear during extreme conditions.

Protective Helmets

Any player eligible to participate in Junior cricket must wear a helmet fitted with a face grille when batting in a Senior match.

Junior competition helmet requirements are contained in the Junior Playing Conditions.

Breaches

A player must not take the field in attire that does not comply with this Policy.

A breach of this Playing Attire Policy may be dealt with under Regulation 1.14 and Appendix 5.7.

6.10. UMPIRE PAYMENT FEE SCHEDULE

The 2026/27 BHRDCA Umpires Association Fee schedule approved by the BHRDCA CoM is as follows:

BHRDCA Umpire Payments 2026/27 (Per Day, Per Umpire, Per Club)				
GRADE	1 Umpire Payment		2 Umpires Payment	
	Payment	Per Club	Payment	Per Club
80 Overs	\$ 200.00	\$ 100.00	\$ 200.00	\$ 200.00
70 Overs	\$ 190.00	\$ 95.00	\$ 190.00	\$ 190.00
64 Overs	\$ 180.00	\$ 90.00	\$ 180.00	\$ 180.00
T20	\$ 100.00	\$ 50.00	\$ 100.00	\$ 100.00
Junior's U18's	\$ 100.00	\$ 50.00	\$ 100.00	\$ 100.00
Veterans	\$ 170.00	\$ 85.00	\$ 170.00	\$ 170.00
Senior Women's	\$ 160.00	\$ 80.00	\$ 160.00	\$ 160.00
Senior Women's T20	\$ 120.00	\$ 60.00	\$ 120.00	\$ 120.00
Girls T20	\$ 100.00	\$ 50.00	\$ 100.00	\$ 100.00

6.11. BEST CONDUCTED CLUB AWARD

The BHRDCA Best Conducted Club Award is assessed across a total of one hundred (100) points, comprising forty (40) On Field points and sixty (60) Off Field points. This is broken into the following with some examples:

On Field (40 total): Umpires reporting, individual behaviour (red & yellow cards, GCIR's).

Off Field (60 total): Attendance at BHRDCA Meetings and Events, administrative compliance, paying invoices on time, endorsing Cricket Victoria initiative to grow participation.